

Classical Guitar Method

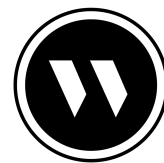
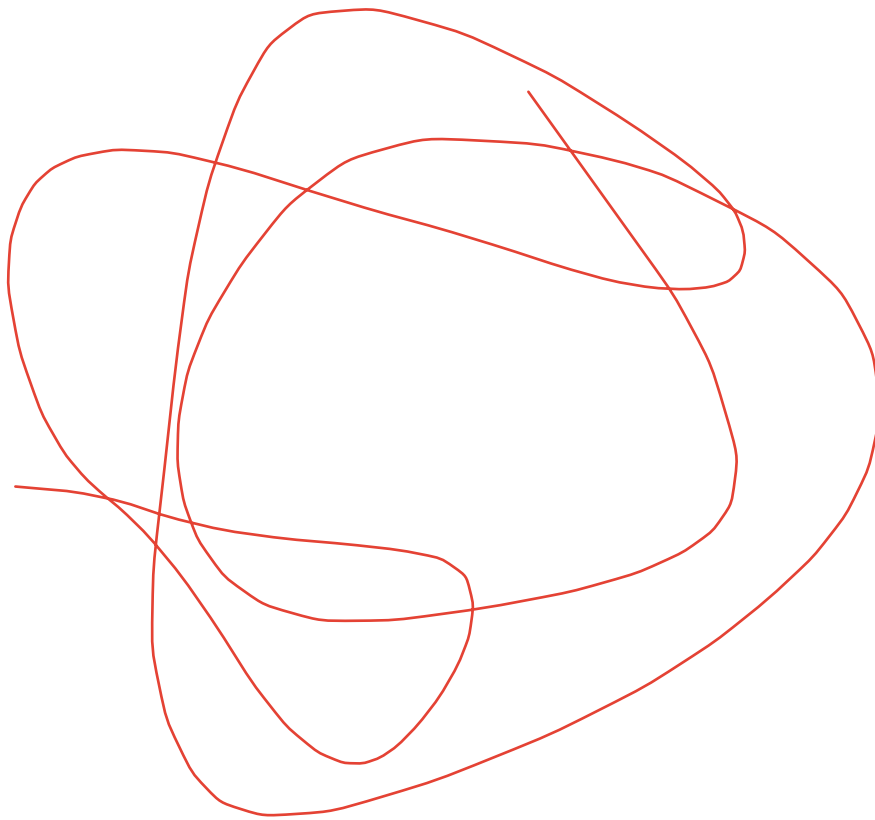
Volume 1

By Bradford Werner

wernerguitareditions.com

thisisclassicalguitar.com

2020 Edition



WERNER
GUITAR
EDITIONS

Classical Guitar Method - Volume 1

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2020 Edition

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Printing the PDF

This PDF has been designed for double sided printing. Place it in a three ring binder with dividers for each section. You are not permitted to print and sell this book.

Hard Copies

Physical print editions of this book are available on Amazon Stores online.

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About this book

This book teaches classical and fingerstyle guitar skills with a focus on the rich pedagogical tradition of classical guitar. Most learning objectives are covered through pieces and duets rather than exercises or descriptions. This allows students to perform full pieces from the first lesson. Working with a qualified teacher as well as watching the lesson videos should provide students with a healthy start to guitar.

How to use this book

Study *Part 1* in order, covering every piece on every page. Simultaneously begin *Part 3* as a technique routine. *Part 2* (chords) can be studied more loosely based on the skills and age of the student. Watch the video lessons to help you learn proper technique, musicality, and listening skills.

Free video lessons, an essential part of this method

The video lessons for this book are essential to the learning experience. Ideas about musicality and technique are discussed and demonstrated in the videos. This book omits information that might clutter the beginner learning experience. Music should be learned through listening and experience. All the extra information and advice has been included in the free lesson videos which is a better medium for communicating musical ideas. Find the lessons at the method book page at Werner Guitar Editions or This is Classical Guitar (also via the sheet music page or lesson page):

<https://www.thisisclassicalguitar.com/free-classical-guitar-method-book-pdf/>

Five main goals of this book

1. Play solos and duets from start to finish with a steady tempo
2. Play legato melodies (also with open string bass accompaniment)
3. Play arpeggio pieces and patterns
4. Become proficient at reading music in first position (without key signatures)
5. Accompany basic songs with strumming or fingerstyle chords

Educational Series (Further Study)

- **Method Book Volume 2** - Continue your progress with new repertoire, techniques, key signatures, scales, time signatures; theory, musicality, rhythm training; new chords and more.
- **Repertoire Lessons Grade 1 to 6** - A dedicated book of lessons and repertoire for each grade. All the pieces come with dedicated lesson pages and video lessons to help you learn.
- **Classical Guitar Technique, Essential Scales, Arpeggios, and Exercises** - Routines for all levels, hundreds of exercises, video lessons.

Rest stroke or free stroke? Nails?

Teachers have different opinions about the use of rest and free strokes for beginners. I have seen good results from both approaches. My beginner students use free stroke until proper hand positions and a relaxed legato playing style are established. Students need not introduce right hand nails until hand positions and posture are secure. I introduce rest strokes and nails during my Volume 2 method.

Use of the left hand pinky finger

Students should use the left hand pinky for D and G (3rd fret of the 1st and 2nd strings). This fingering is required for solo pieces later and helps align the left hand. Students will have no trouble using the pinky if it is curved and in the proper position.

Music Theory

I recommend the *Berklee Music Theory Book 1* - Intro to theory which also includes an answer key. You don't really need all this theory info yet but if you're curious this is a good place to start. You can find the book link on my site or on Amazon here: <https://amzn.to/2K1TeHw>

Tuning the guitar

Students should buy a clip-on tuner, I like the D'Addario Micro Tuner: <http://amzn.to/2pecdpN>

Tuning by ear to the teacher should begin during the first lesson as well as relative tuning:

1. Play the 6th string at the 5th fret and tune the open 5th string to the same pitch.
2. Play the 5th string at the 5th fret to tune the open 4th string.
3. Play the 4th string at the 5th fret to tune the open 3rd string.
4. Play the 3rd string at the 4th fret to tune the open 2nd string.
5. Play the 2nd string at the 5th fret to tune the open 1st string.

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Practice Advice

Happiness in small goals: Making your practice sessions enjoyable will be key to long-term musical success and development. When experiencing difficulties, break up the piece or exercise into small manageable goals at a speed you can accomplish successfully. Even if you only play a few notes at a time, playing successfully will improve your skills and give you a feeling of accomplishment.

Isolate difficulties and solidify strengths: Balance your practice sessions by working on difficulties as well as maintaining easy material you can play well. Playing at a high quality level as often as possible will help develop a solid foundation. Work on your difficulties near the middle of your practice session and finish with something you can play well. This will ensure you end with a positive feeling of success.

Practicing is Problem Solving: Practicing is different than just playing the guitar. When you practice you need to identify problems or elements you wish to improve and solve them immediately. Simply playing the guitar will not make you a better musician. If your teacher says you should practice for 30 minutes a day, be sure you are actually *practicing* for 30 minutes not just playing.

Combine repetition with thoughtful practice: Although a certain amount of repetition is required to establish your skills, balance repetition with thoughtful reevaluation. Sometimes, improvement will occur by reexamining your posture, hand positions, or elements not directly connected to what you are studying. Having a qualified teacher is very helpful. They can identify problems before you repeat it a hundred times. That said, aim to be mindful at all times about what you are doing.

Good days vs bad days: Actually, I don't believe in good or bad practice days. All days are good opportunities to practice something. On days when you are having trouble focusing or executing material cleanly, slow down your speed and use a metronome until you are playing well. You may have to play at half the speed you intended but you can still get in some quality practice.

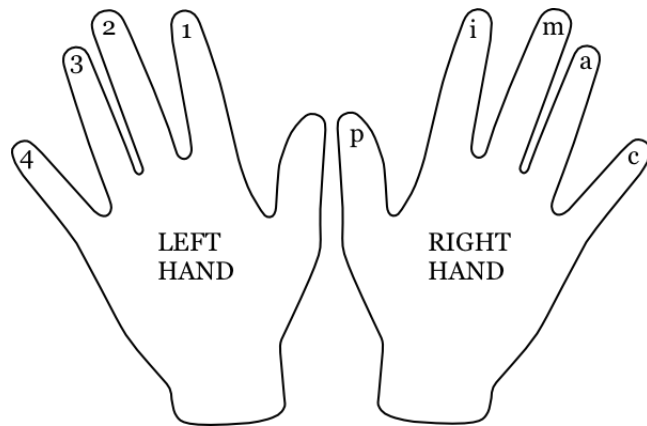
Play slowly: I've rarely encountered a student who practices as slowly as I think they should. Practicing ultra slowly will ensure you are playing with your best hand positions, sound, confidence, relaxation, accuracy, and more. The majority of your practicing should be at very slow tempos. Once you can play something well at a slow tempo, you can speed it up while keeping an eye on the quality level.

Page markers: Use page markers (sticky tabs) on the pages you are practicing so you can quickly flip to the next piece or exercise.

Keep it simple: Even the most advanced players will practice simple open string exercises but will do so at a very high quality level. Quality practice helps to improve your playing so keep the exercises and pieces simple enough that you can accomplish them at your highest potential. You don't have to prove yourself to anyone. You'll only improve if you set realistic and manageable goals.

Trust your teacher: If your teacher recommends something contrary to what's in this book, please trust their advice. Your teacher knows what's best for you and your personal and unique development. Learning from books and online videos can be helpful but the real work is done through long-term communication with teachers and other musicians.

Getting Started - Finger Names



Left Hand Finger Names

- 1 = index
- 2 = middle
- 3 = ring
- 4 = pinky

Right Hand Finger Names

- p = thumb
- i = index
- m = middle
- a = ring
- c = pinky

Anatomy of the Classical Guitar

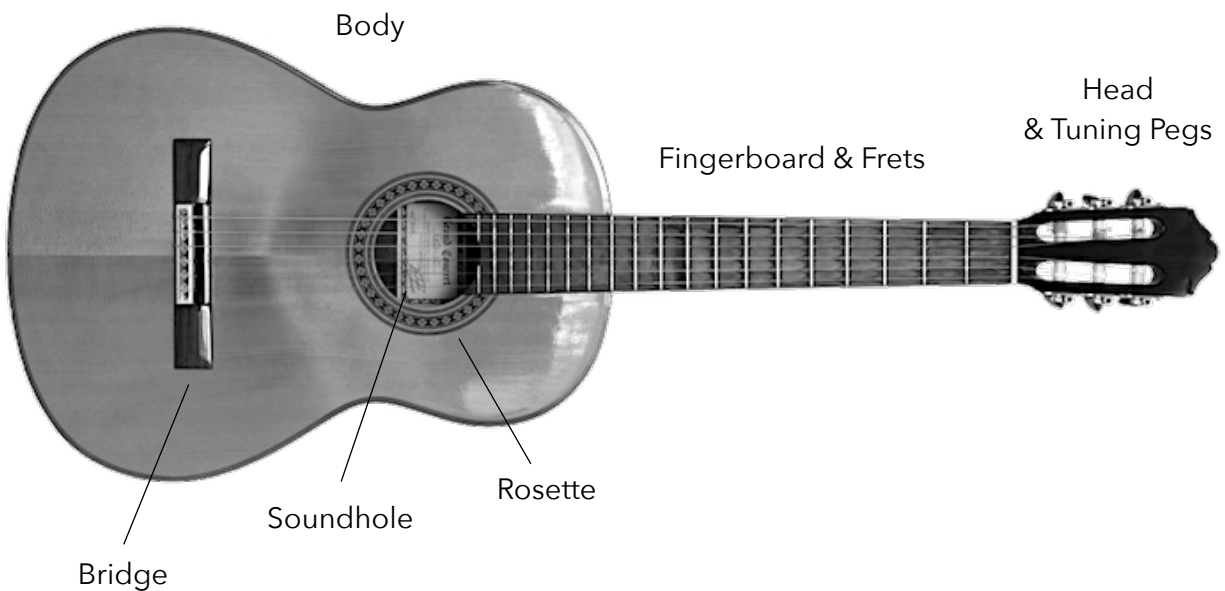


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Hand and Sitting Positions for Classical Guitar

See more photos and video lessons on posture and hand positions: thisisclassicalguitar.com/lessons/

Sitting Position

- The head of the guitar is at eye level (guitar is at a 45° angle)
- Face of guitar straight up and down (not angled back)
- Sit up straight and relax the shoulders and neck

Right Arm & Hand

- Right forearm rests on the guitar in front of the elbow
- Right wrist is straight with a relaxed arch
- Right hand plays around the rosette
- Right hand fingers move into the palm, not up and away
- Right hand thumb is in front of the fingers

Left Arm & Hand

- Left hand thumb is vertical and behind 2nd finger
- Left palm and knuckles are parallel with the strings
- Left wrist is straight, not over-extended
- Left hand fingers are curved and contact the strings on the fingertips



Head of guitar at eye level (guitar at 45° angle)



Same position applies to guitar supports

Beat, Tempo, Notes

Before you begin reading music, review these basic music notation terms and symbols. You can also see the article on the website that includes videos to help you get oriented.

The **beat**, also called **pulse**, is the basic unit of time in a piece of music. For example, if you listen to a song and begin to tap your foot at regular intervals you are likely tapping 'the beat'.

The word **tempo** is used to describe the how fast or slow the beat is moving.

Notes are symbols used in music to represent the pitch and rhythm of a standard musical sound. **Pitch** refers to how high or low a note sounds. The **Rhythm** indicates when to play a pitch.

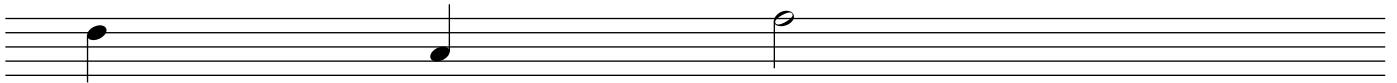
Anatomy of a note:

● ○ Noteheads

♪ ○ Noteheads with stems

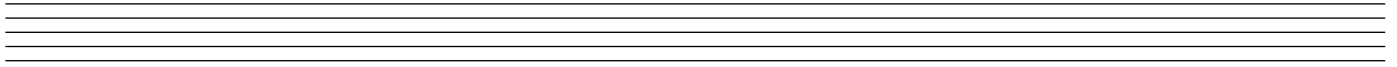
♪ Stems with flags

Notes will be placed on a staff (5 lines), as shown below.



Basic Musical Symbols

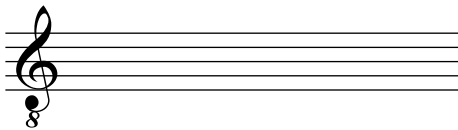
The **Staff** has five lines.



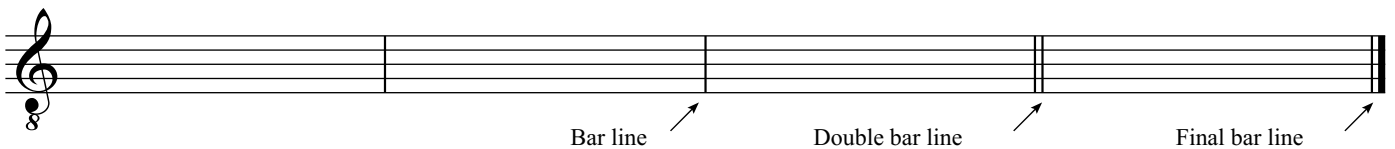
The **Treble Clef Sign** is used in guitar notation (also called the G Clef). The clef indicates which notes are represented by the lines and spaces on a staff. The bottom circular part of the treble clef designates the second to bottom line as G. There are other clefs in music, but guitar primarily uses the treble clef so that's all you need to know for now.



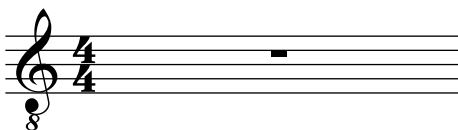
A treble clef with an 8 below is often used in guitar notation. Guitar sounds one octave below where it's written (we'll learn more about that later).



Bars, also called **Measures**, are used to divide the staff into sections. Bar lines divide the staff into bars. Double bar lines usually mark the end of a section. Final bar lines mark the end of a composition (song or piece).



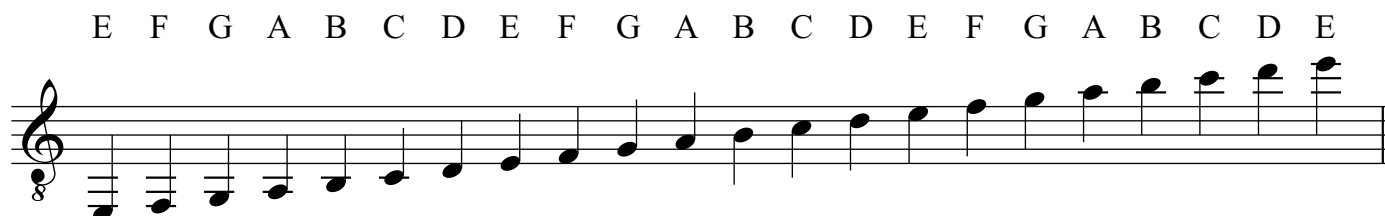
The **Time Signature** tells you how many beats are in each bar and what type of note equals one beat. Beginners only need to know about the top number for now.



The top number states how many beats are in each bar.
The bottom number states the rhythmic value of each beat.

Notes & Rhythms

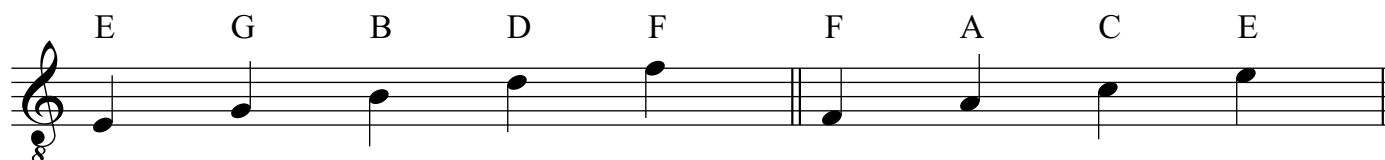
The below staff shows standard music notation starting on the lowest note of the guitar. The lines above and below the staff are called **Ledger Lines** which extend the range of the staff. Notice how the note names go up in the order of the musical alphabet: A - B - C - D - E - F - G and then repeat at a higher pitch. There are actually twelve notes in the musical alphabet but we'll learn about that later.



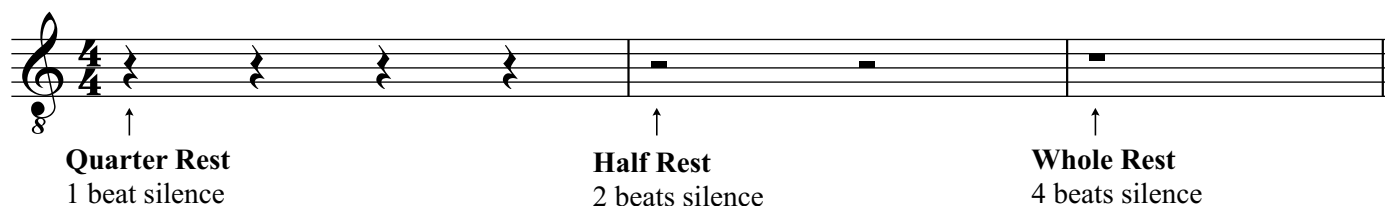
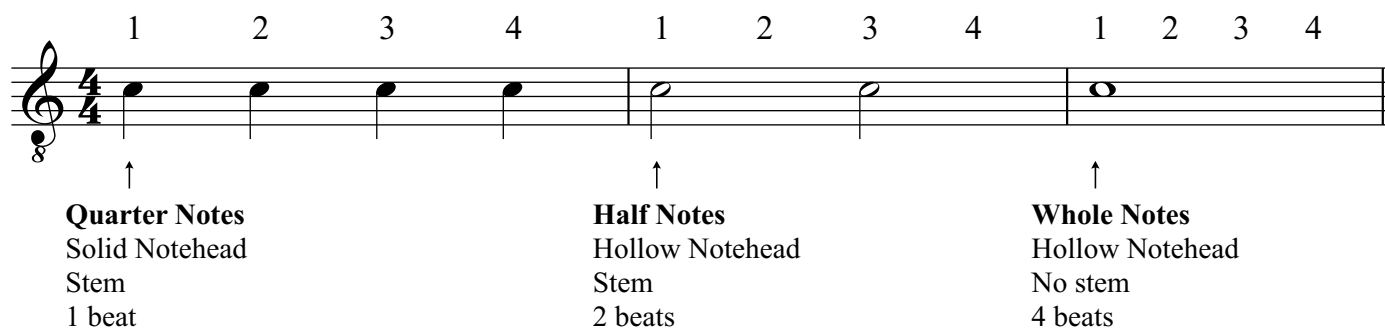
Notes can be placed on the lines or the spaces of the staff to indicate the pitch.

Line Notes Memorization: Every Good Bear Deserves Fish.

Space Notes Memorization: FACE



Rhythm & Beat Values - Beginners only require a simple explanation of rhythmic note values to begin. The below example has a time signature of 4 beats per bar. I've written the beats above each bar. The bottom example shows musical **rests** which are indications of silence that correspond to rhythmic values.



Notes for Etude No. 1

Numbers above the notes indicate the left hand fingering.
 E, B, and G are open strings so they all have "0" above them.
 The high E string (1st string) is the string closest to your feet.
 It is called high because it is high in pitch.

E **B** **G**
 0 0 0

1st string open 2nd string open 3rd string open

Continue writing the note names and string numbers. You don't need to play these notes.

Name: **E** **B** **G** **E** *E* *B* *E* *B* *E* *B*

String: **1** **2** **3** **1**

Name: **E** **B**

String: **1** **2**

Rhythms for Etude No. 1

Place your right hand thumb on a bass string.
Say the right hand fingering as you play.
Count the beat as you play.

Quarter Notes

Count: 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4



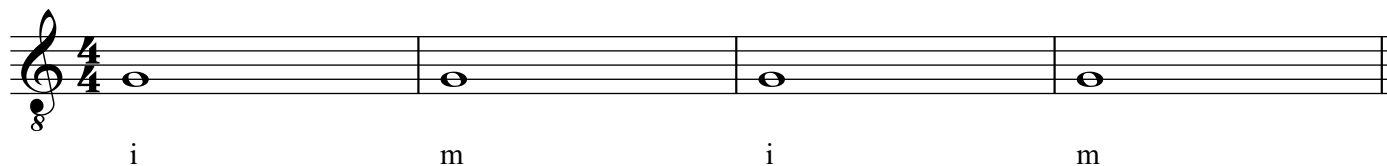
Half Notes

Count: 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4



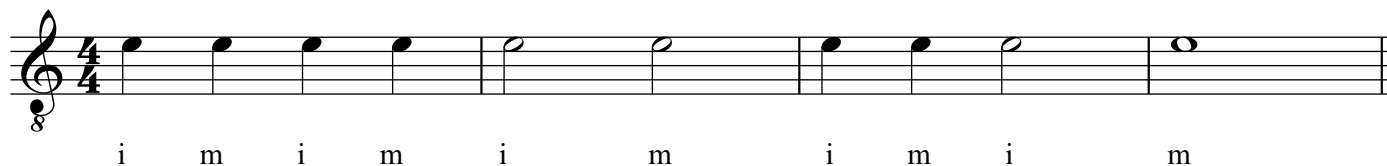
Whole Notes

Count: 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4



Mixed Rhythms

Count: 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4



Etude No. 1 - Melody

Place your right hand thumb on a bass string to stabilize the hand.

1. Name the notes without playing
2. Name the rhythms without playing (quarter, half, whole)
3. Say the right hand fingering as you play
4. Count the beat as you play

Count: 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4

i m i m i m i m i m i m i m i m

Continue Counting

i m i m i m i m i m i m

i m i m i m i m i m i m

i m i m i m i m i m i

Etude No. 2 - Arpeggios

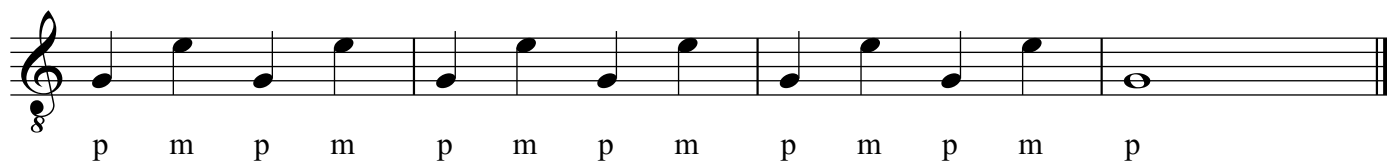
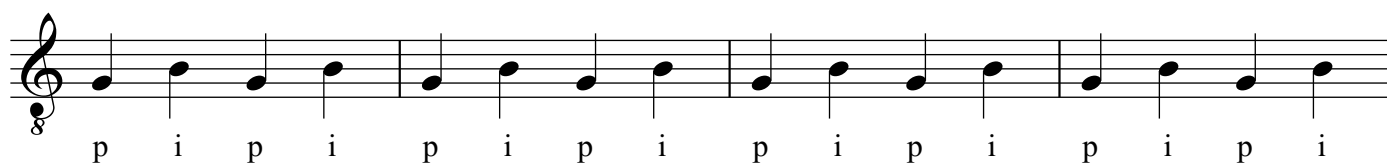
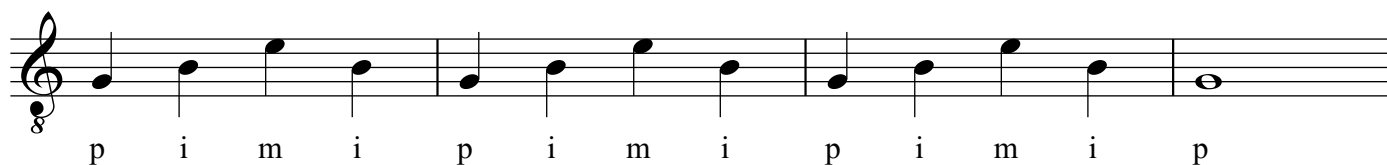
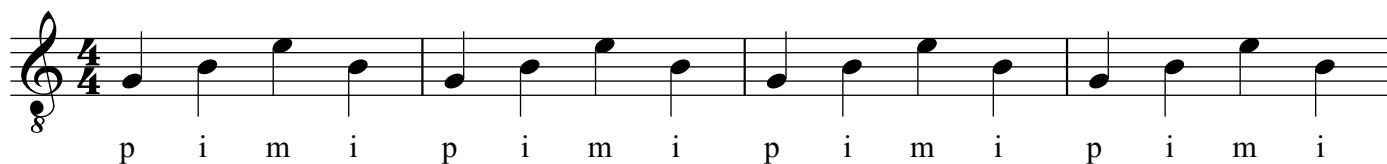
Arpeggios are notes of a chord played in succession instead of all together.

Let all notes sustain (ring) and count out loud.

Keep the right hand thumb in front of the fingers at all times.

rit. = *Ritardando* indicating a slowing down of the tempo.

Slowly



rit. - - - - -

Nocturne Duet

The student plays the top staff as a solo or duet with a teacher.

Also see the play-along videos for duets in this book.

Stop the sound during bars with *whole note rests* (bar 2 and 4).

Both lines have *repeat signs*. In this song you repeat each line once.

Count out loud as you play.

repeat to the beginning

Count: 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4

Student

Teacher

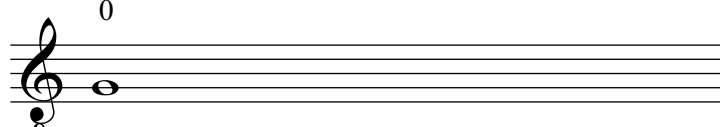
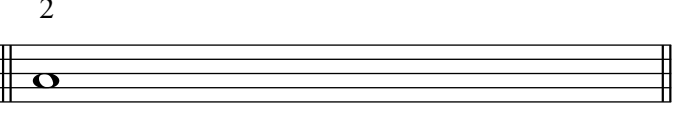
repeat 2nd line from here

repeat

1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4

Notes on the Third String

This is a great time to watch or review the left hand technique video.
The numbers above the notes in guitar music indicate the left hand fingering.
Open String (0), Index (1), Middle (2), Ring (3), Pinky (4).

G 0	A 2
	
3rd string open	3rd string 2nd fret 2nd finger

Complete the following note names, frets, and strings



Name: **G** **A**

Fret: **0** **2**

String: **3** **3**



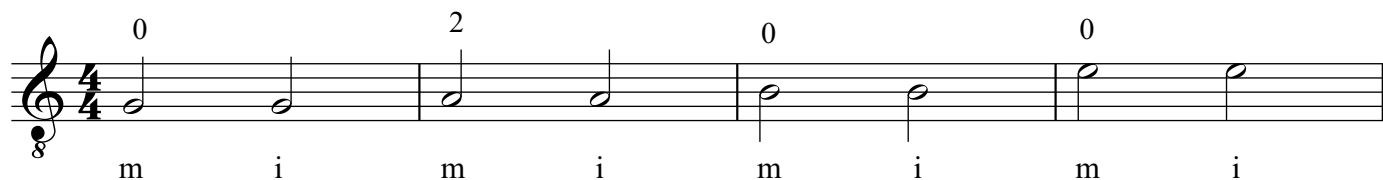
Name: **A** **B**

Fret: **2** **0**

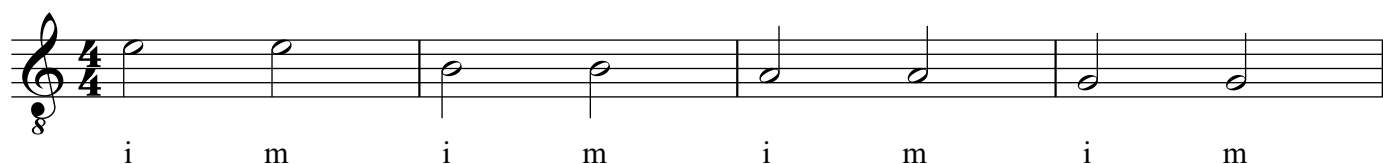
String: **3** **2**

Sight Reading & Review

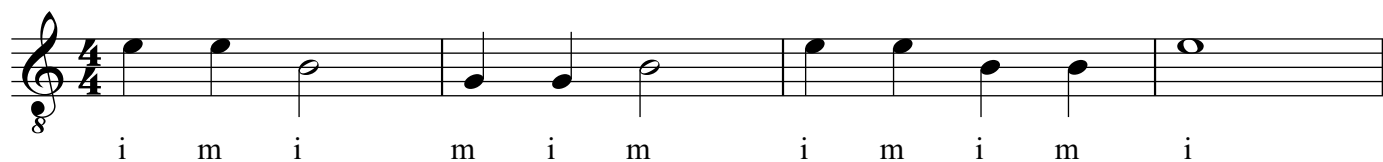
1. Ascending Note Review



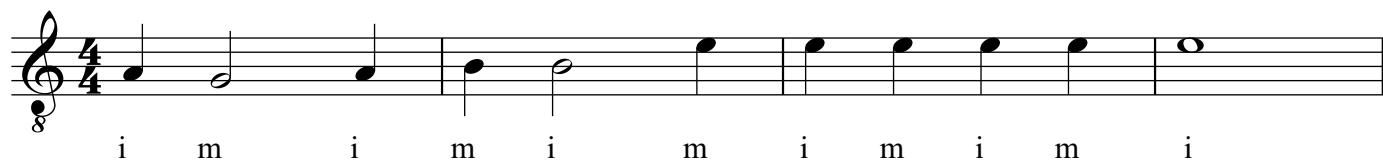
2. Descending Note Review



3. Rhythm Review on Open Strings



4. Rhythm Review with All Notes



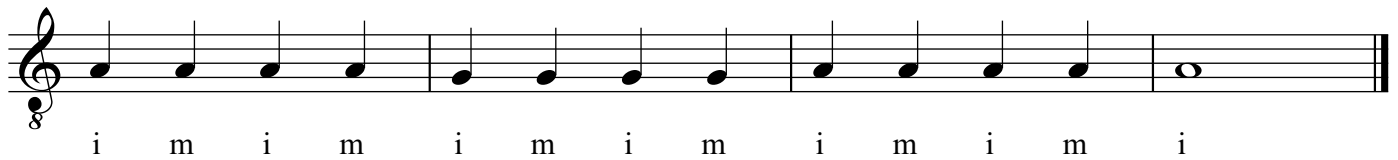
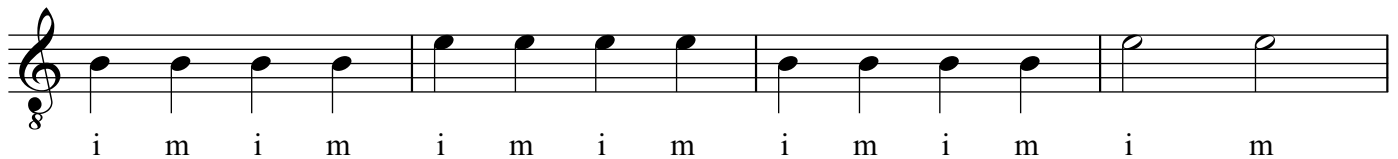
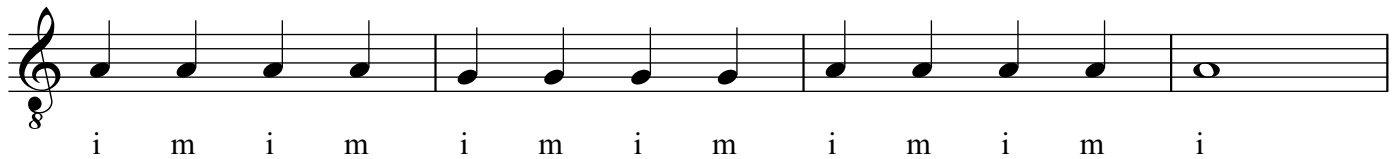
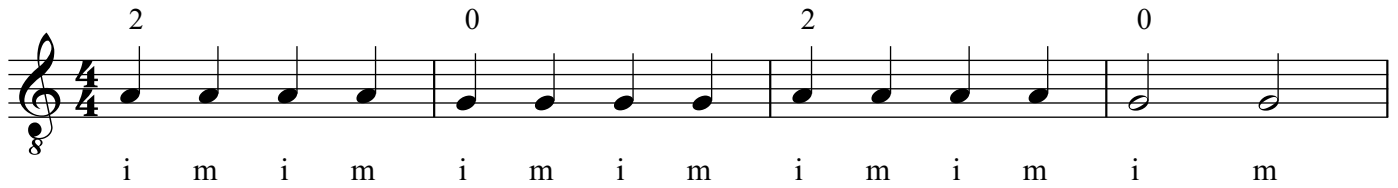
Moderato

Say the note names out loud as you play. *Moderato* indicates a moderate tempo.

Keep your left hand fingers curved, on the fingertips, and close to the fret.

Playing close to the fret will stop buzzing and allow for a light touch.

Place the right hand thumb on a bass string.



A Fairy Tale

The student plays the top staff as a solo or duet.

Also see the play-along videos for duets in this book.

This piece has 3 beats per bar as indicated by the *time signature*.

Count: 1-2-3 for each bar.

The sheet music for "A Fairy Tale" is presented in four systems, each consisting of a top staff (treble clef) and a bottom staff (bass clef). The time signature is 3/4, indicated by a '3' over the '4'. The top staff uses fingerings 'i' and 'm' for the notes. The bottom staff provides a bass line with chords and single notes. The piece consists of 16 measures in total, with a repeat sign at the end of the fourth system.

System 1: Measures 1-4. Top staff: i m | i m i | m | i. Bottom staff: chords and single notes.

System 2: Measures 5-8. Top staff: m i m | i m i | m | i. Bottom staff: chords and single notes.

System 3: Measures 9-12. Top staff: m i m | i | m i m | i. Bottom staff: chords and single notes.

System 4: Measures 13-16. Top staff: m | i m i m | i | m. Bottom staff: chords and single notes. The system ends with a repeat sign.

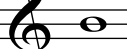
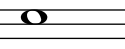
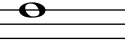
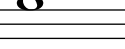
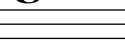
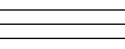
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Sheet Music with Videos: wernerguitareditions.com

Lessons, Pro Video, & Blog: thisisclassicalguitar.com

Notes on the First & Second Strings

The following notes use a similar pattern: open string, 1st fret, 3rd fret. Use the 4th finger on D and G as solo pieces will require in later grades.

B	C	D	E	F	G
0	1	4	0	1	4
					
2nd string open	2nd string 1st fret 1st finger	2nd string 3rd fret 4th finger	1st string open	1st string 1st fret 1st finger	1st string 3rd fret 4th finger

Complete the following note names, frets, and strings



Name: **D** **C**

Fret: **3** **1**

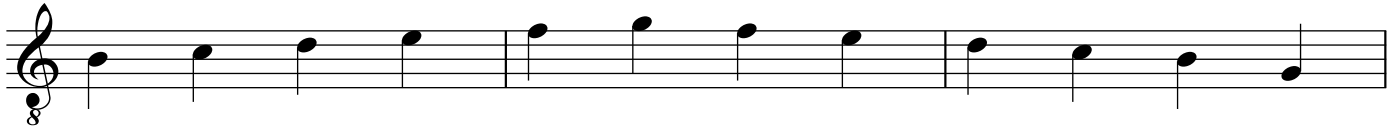
String: **2** **2**

Name: **G F**

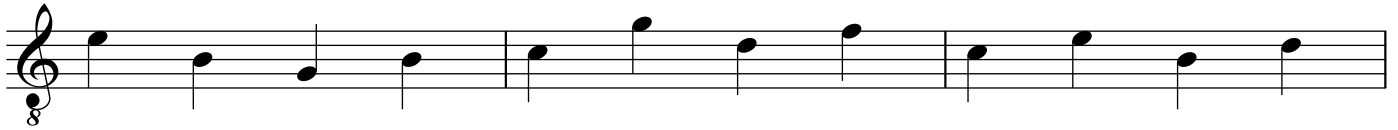
Fret: **3 1**

String: **1 1**

Note Review

Name: **B** **C**Fret: **0** **1**

String: **2** **2**



Name:

Fret:

String:



Name:

Fret:

String:

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Sight Reading & Review

Say the note names out loud as you play the following exercises.
Keep left hand fingers curved, play on fingertips very close to the fret.
Playing close to the fret will stop buzzing and allow for a light touch.
Place the right hand thumb on a bass string.

Second String Notes

First String Notes

Both Strings Without Fingering

m i m i m i m i m i m i

Five Melodies

Say the note names out loud as you play.
Place the right hand thumb on a bass string.

The Mountain

1 4 0 1 4

i m i m i m i m i m i m i m

1 0 4 1 0 1

i m i m i m i m i m i m i

Theme by Joseph Haydn (1732-1809)

m i m i m i m i m i m i m i

m i m i m i m i m i m i m i

Lightly Row

8

i m i m i m i m i m

Go Tell Aunt Rhody

[illegible]

The Fox

This cunning little piece encourages proper left hand technique through listening skills.

Let all notes sustain by keeping C and D down while you play the open E string.

You will have to stay on your fingertips and curve your fingers to avoid muting the 1st string!

4/4

i m i m i m i m etc.

Ode to Joy

Ludwig van Beethoven
(1770-1827)

The student plays the top part as a solo or duet.
The dotted quarter note and eighth note rhythms in bar 4, 8, and 16
should be played by ear (as you naturally hear the melody).
These rhythms will be taught later.

First system of musical notation for 'Ode to Joy'. It consists of a treble and bass staff in 4/4 time. The treble staff has a key signature of one flat (B-flat) and a common time signature of 4/4. The melody is written in the treble staff, and the bass staff provides a simple harmonic accompaniment. The lyrics 'm i m i' are written under the first two measures, followed by 'm i m i etc.' under the next two measures. The notation includes a fermata over the final note of the melody in the fourth measure.

Second system of musical notation for 'Ode to Joy'. It continues the melody and accompaniment from the first system. The notation includes a fermata over the final note of the melody in the fourth measure.

Third system of musical notation for 'Ode to Joy'. It continues the melody and accompaniment from the second system. The notation includes a fermata over the final note of the melody in the fourth measure.

Fourth system of musical notation for 'Ode to Joy'. It continues the melody and accompaniment from the third system. The notation includes a fermata over the final note of the melody in the fourth measure.

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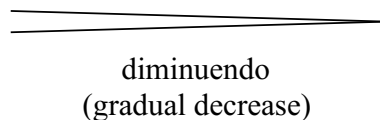
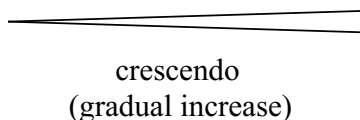
Sight Reading & Dynamics

Dynamics indicate changes in volume and can bring any melody to life. Dynamics are not always marked on the page but musicians add them for expressive effect. Here are a few examples of dynamics you might see:

p
piano
(soft)

mf
mezzo forte
(medium)

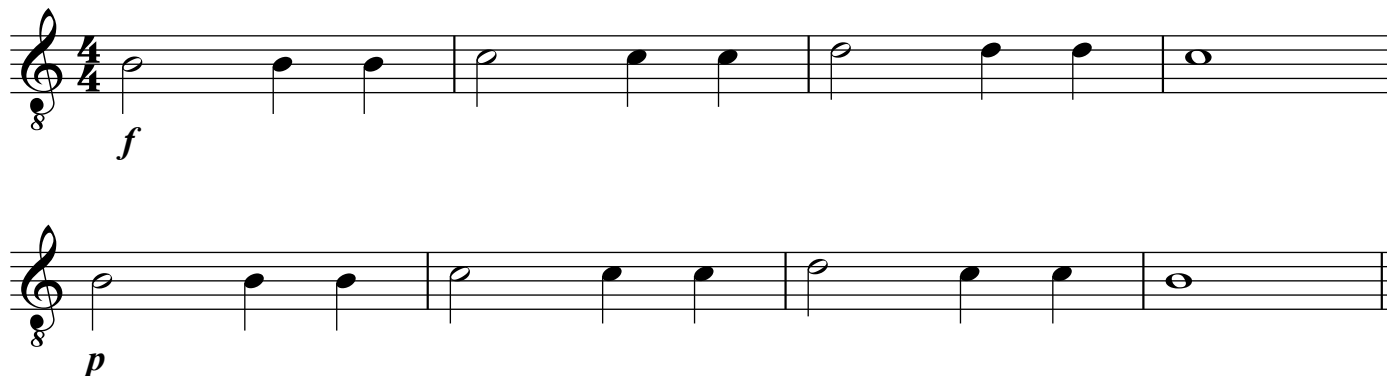
f
forte
(loud)



Play the following example of crescendo and diminuendo

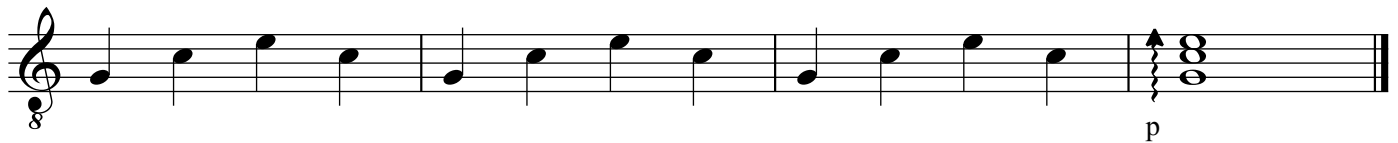
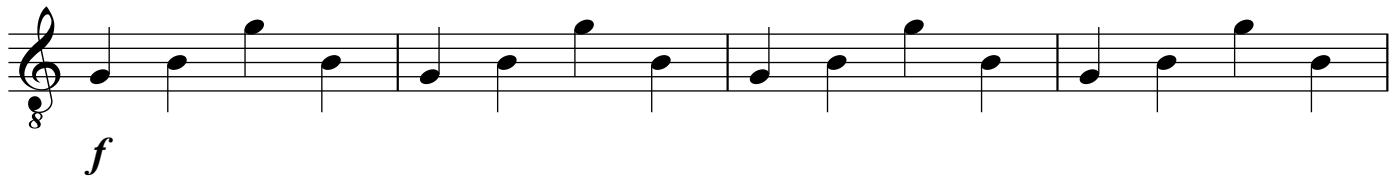


Play the following example of an echo effect (loud first line, soft second line)



Etude No.3 - Sound Picture

Remember to keep the right hand thumb in front of the fingers.
Strum the final chord from the 3rd string to the 1st string.
Follow the dynamics very carefully.



rit.

Note Review

Name the following notes



Name: **G** **A** **B**

Fret: **0** **2** **0**

String: **3** **3** **2**



Name: **G** **G**

Fret: **3** **0**

String: **1** **3**



Name: **G** **E**

Fret: **3** **0**

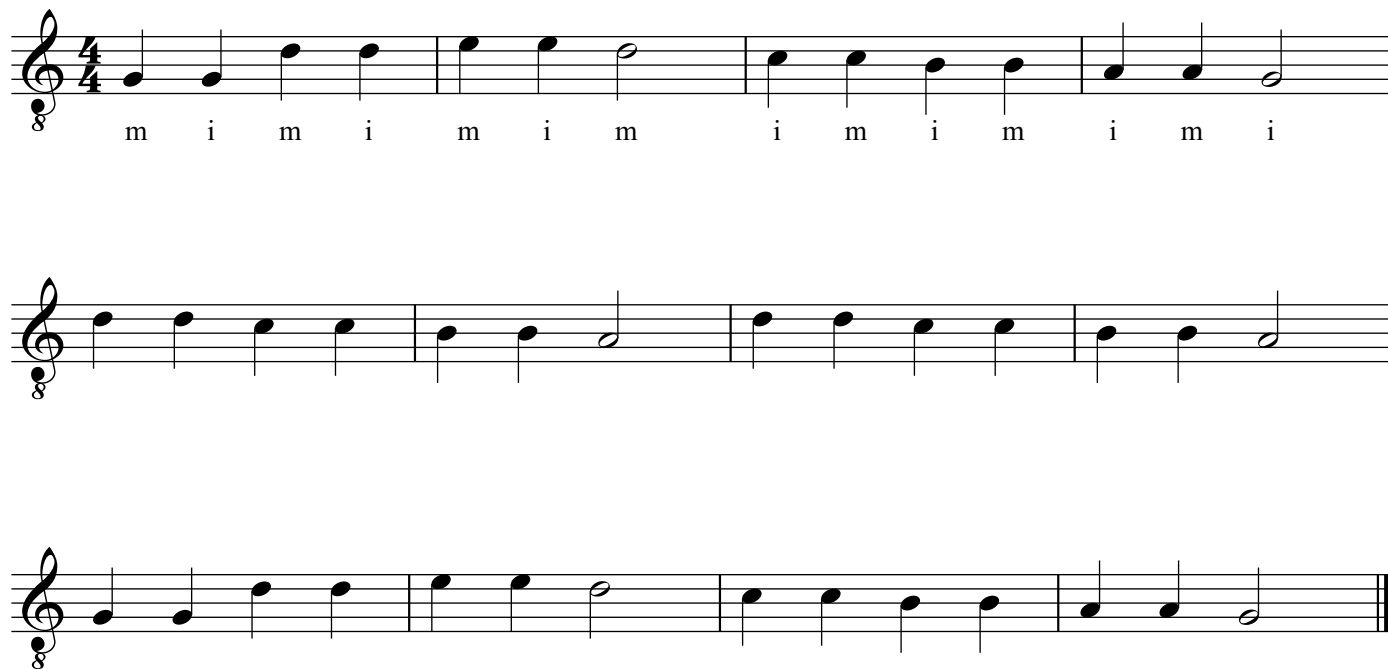
String: **1** **1**

Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star

Phrasing tip: sing the words as you play and imitate your voice.

Avoid emphasizing each syllable/note equally.

Do your best to alternate right hand fingers after the first line.



Lyrics

Twinkle, twinkle, little star,
How I wonder what you are.
Up above the world so high,
Like a diamond in the sky.
Twinkle, twinkle, little star,
How I wonder what you are.

Etude No.4 - The Birds

Hold down all the notes within each bar and let sustain.
Notice the time signature indicates only three beats per bar.
Play slowly and count 1-2-3 for each bar.

8 p i m p i m *mf*

8

8

p

8

f

8

mf *rit.*

Fermata (hold longer)

Jazz Cat

The student reads the notes and ignores the written chords.

The teacher plays the chords (leave out the 7ths if needed).

Accompaniment can be strummed or fingerstyle.

Vary the accompaniment pattern to encourage musical flexibility.

Cmaj⁷ G⁷ Cmaj⁷ Am⁷ G⁷ E⁷ Am⁷ G⁷

mf

Cmaj⁷ Dm⁷ G⁷ Am⁷ Dm⁷ E⁷ Am⁷ G⁷

p

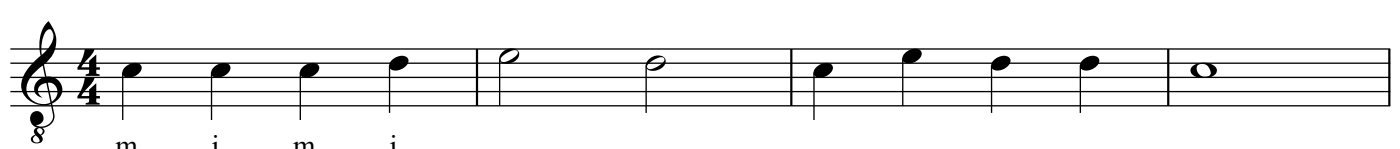
Cmaj⁷ G⁷ Cmaj⁷ Am⁷ Dm⁷ G⁷ Cmaj⁷

mf

Au clair de la lune

The student plays the notes (ignore the letters indicating chords).
The teacher accompanies with chords (strumming and fingerstyle),
and should vary the accompaniment pattern to encourage musical flexibility.

C G C G C

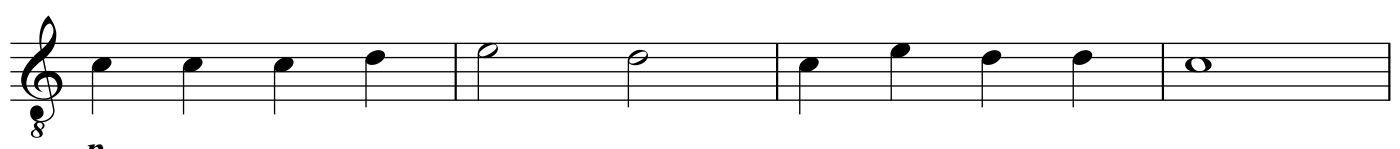


8 m i m i

mf

Detailed description: This is the first system of the musical score. It features a treble clef, a 4/4 time signature, and a key signature of one flat (Bb). The melody consists of quarter notes in the first two measures (Bb4, D5, Bb4, G4) and half notes in the last two measures (F4, E4). Chord letters C, G, C, G, and C are placed above the measures. A finger number '8' is written below the first note. The dynamic marking *mf* is at the bottom left.

C G C G C

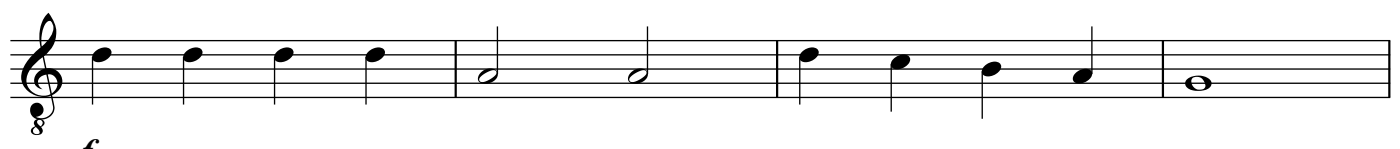


8

p

Detailed description: This is the second system of the musical score. It continues the melody from the first system. Chord letters C, G, C, G, and C are placed above the measures. A finger number '8' is written below the first note. The dynamic marking *p* is at the bottom left.

Dm G

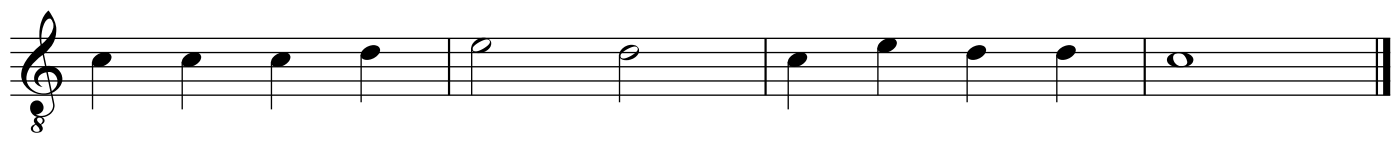


8

f

Detailed description: This is the third system of the musical score. The melody continues with quarter notes in the first two measures (D4, C4) and half notes in the last two measures (B3, A3). Chord letters Dm and G are placed above the measures. A finger number '8' is written below the first note. The dynamic marking *f* is at the bottom left.

C G C G C



8

mf

Detailed description: This is the fourth system of the musical score. The melody continues with quarter notes in the first two measures (G3, F3) and half notes in the last two measures (E3, D3). Chord letters C, G, C, G, and C are placed above the measures. A finger number '8' is written below the first note. The dynamic marking *mf* is at the bottom left. The system ends with a double bar line.

Oh! Susanna

Stephen Foster
(1826–1864)

The student plays the notes. The teacher accompanies with chords.

A starting note that doesn't begin on the first beat of the bar is called a *pickup*.

Count the missing beats in the pickup bar (the first note begins on beat 4).

The note near the end of the first line is called a ***dotted half note*** and counts for 3 beats.

Play the notes with alternating *i-m* as best you can.

Count: 1 2 3 4 G D

I come from A - la - bam - a with a ban - jo on my knee. We're

G D G

goin' to Louis - i - an - a my true love for to see.

C G D

Oh Su - san - na oh don't you cry for me; I

G D G

come from Al - a - bam - a with my ban - jo on my knee.

Waltz

Carl Czerny
(1791-1857)

The student plays the top part as a solo or duet. Notice the dynamics and *phrase marks* indicating *legato*: a smooth and connected sound from note to note. The dots above some notes indicate *staccato*: short and disconnected (opposite of legato). Play staccato by placing the next right hand finger on the string early (therefore stopping the sound).

Andantino

The musical score is written for guitar in 3/4 time. It consists of four systems, each with a treble and bass staff. The first system begins with a piano (*p*) dynamic. The melody in the treble staff uses slurs for legato passages and staccato dots for short notes. The bass staff provides a simple accompaniment of half notes. The second system includes crescendo and decrescendo hairpins. The third system also starts with a piano (*p*) dynamic. The fourth system concludes with a repeat sign and a final double bar line.

Minuet

C. H. Wilton
(1761-1832)

The student plays the top part as a solo or duet.
Notice the phrasing and dynamics as well as the special fingering in bar 9.
This fingering allows you to play legato from D to G without jumping the
same finger over to a new string.

Andantino

The musical score is written for guitar in 3/4 time. It consists of four systems of two staves each. The top staff is in treble clef and the bottom staff is in bass clef. The first system starts with a mezzo-forte (*mf*) dynamic. The second system features a crescendo hairpin. The third system starts with a piano (*p*) dynamic and includes a crescendo (*cres.*) hairpin. The fourth system returns to mezzo-forte (*mf*). The score includes various musical notations such as notes, rests, slurs, and fingering numbers (3, 4).

Morning

Anton Diabelli
(1781-1858)

The student plays the top part as a solo or duet.
Notice the phrasing and dynamics.

The sheet music for "Morning" by Anton Diabelli is presented in four systems, each consisting of a piano (p) and guitar (g) staff. The key signature is one flat (B-flat) and the time signature is 4/4. The music is written for a solo or duet performance.

- System 1:** The piano part begins with a *p* (piano) dynamic. The guitar part features a series of chords, with a slur indicating a phrase across the first two measures.
- System 2:** The piano part continues with a series of notes, and the guitar part features a series of chords. A slur indicates a phrase across the first two measures.
- System 3:** The piano part begins with a *mp* (mezzo-piano) dynamic. The guitar part features a series of chords. A slur indicates a phrase across the first two measures. The dynamic changes to *mf* (mezzo-forte) in the third measure.
- System 4:** The piano part begins with a *f* (forte) dynamic. The guitar part features a series of chords. A slur indicates a phrase across the first two measures. The dynamic changes to *p* (piano) in the third measure. The system concludes with a double bar line and repeat dots.

Open Bass Strings

The lines below the staff are called *ledger lines*.
Ledger lines extend the pitch range of the staff.

Diagram showing the open strings of a guitar (6th, 5th, and 4th strings) on a treble clef staff. The notes are E (6th string), A (5th string), and D (4th string), all marked with a '0' indicating they are open. The notes are placed on ledger lines below the staff. The 6th string note is on the third ledger line, the 5th string note is on the second ledger line, and the 4th string note is on the first ledger line.

E 0 A 0 D 0

6th string open 5th string open 4th string open

Name the following notes

Musical notation showing a sequence of notes on a treble clef staff in 4/4 time. The notes are: D4 (quarter), A3 (quarter), E3 (quarter), D4 (quarter), A3 (quarter), E3 (quarter), D4 (quarter), A3 (quarter), E3 (quarter), D4 (quarter), A3 (quarter), E3 (quarter). The notes are written on the staff with ledger lines for the lower notes.

Name: **D** **A** **E**

Fret: **0** **0** **0**

String: **4** **5** **6**

Musical notation showing a sequence of notes on a treble clef staff in 4/4 time. The notes are: G3 (quarter), A3 (quarter), B3 (quarter), C4 (quarter), D4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), F4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), C5 (quarter), D5 (quarter). The notes are written on the staff with ledger lines for the lower notes.

Name: **G** **A**

Fret: **0** **2**

String: **3** **3**

Etude No. 5 - Waltz

This piece combines melody with bass accompaniment. The melody (top three strings) is the prominent musical voice. Play the melody louder than the bass notes. Sustain the melody notes despite their quarter note value (keep fingers down during each bar).

I've used sostenuto marks (dashes) to indicate sustain of the melody notes.

The musical score for Etude No. 5 - Waltz is written in 3/4 time. It consists of four staves of music. The melody is played on the top three strings, and the bass accompaniment is played on the bottom two strings. The score includes fingerings (m, p, i) and a ritardando (rit.) marking.

Staff 1: Melody (top three strings) starts with a sostenuto mark (dash) over the first note. The bass accompaniment (bottom two strings) consists of quarter notes. Fingerings: m, p, p, i, p, p, m, p, p, i, p, p.

Staff 2: Melody continues with a sostenuto mark. The bass accompaniment continues with quarter notes. Fingerings: m, p, p, i, m, i.

Staff 3: Melody continues with a sostenuto mark. The bass accompaniment continues with quarter notes. Fingerings: m, i, m, i.

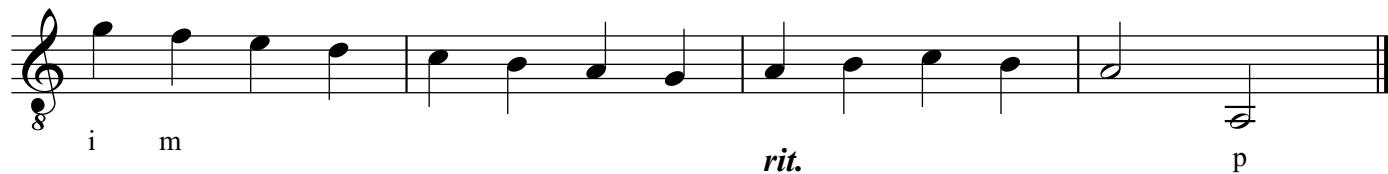
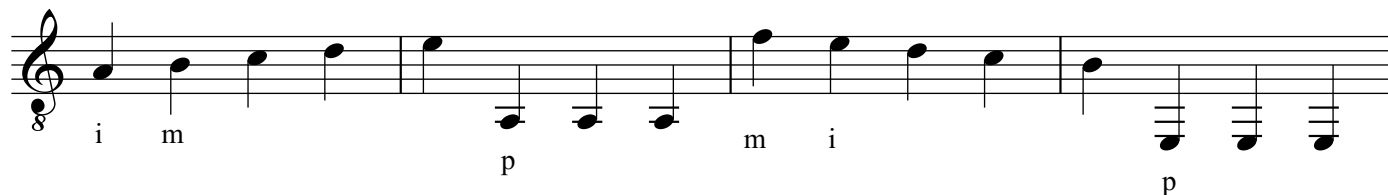
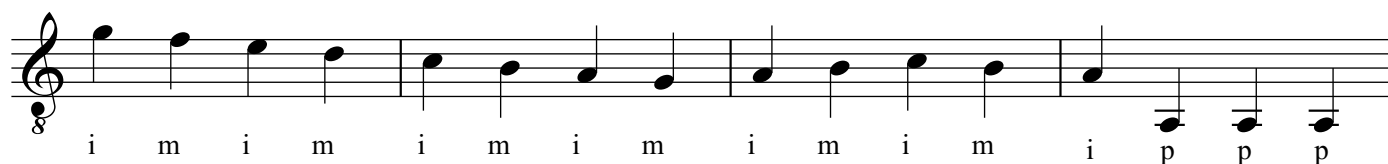
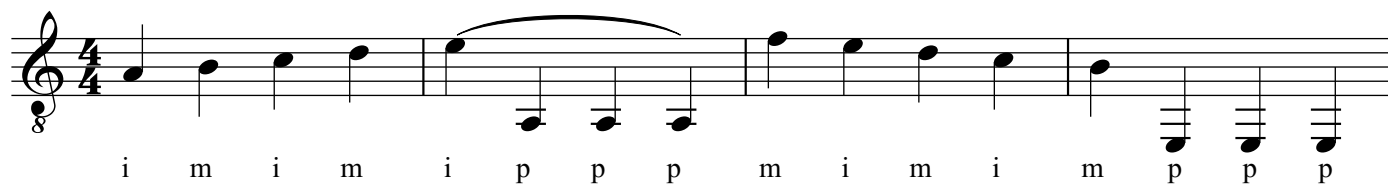
Staff 4: Melody continues with a sostenuto mark. The bass accompaniment continues with quarter notes. Fingerings: m, i, m, p. The piece ends with a double bar line. A *rit.* marking is placed below the staff.

Etude No. 6 - Allegro

Make the melody (top three strings) the prominent voice.

Let the last melody note of each scale run sustain for the entire bar.

Allegro indicates a brisk (fast) tempo but never play faster than you can play well.



Etude No. 7 - The Lonely Dogwood

The Dogwood is a flowering tree and the official tree of British Columbia, Canada.

This piece introduces the *a* finger during arpeggios.

Hold your left hand fingers down and let all notes sustain.

p i m a p i m a

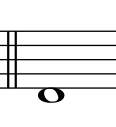
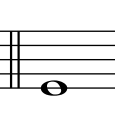
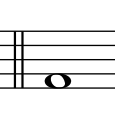
2 1

2 1

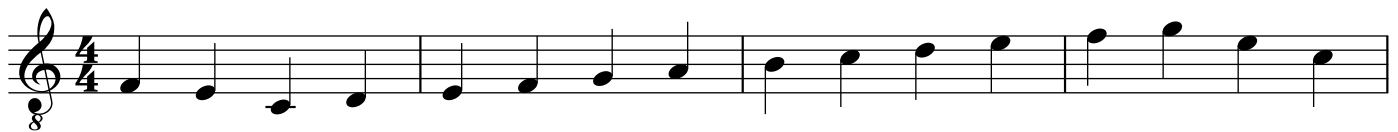
4

rit.

New Notes

C	D	E	F
3	0	2	3
			
5th string 3rd fret 3rd finger	4th string open	4th string 2nd fret 2nd finger	4th string 3rd fret 3rd finger

Complete the following note names, frets, and strings



Name: **F** **E** **C**

Fret: **3** **2** **3**

String: **4** **4** **5**



Name: **A** **F**

Fret: **2** **3**

String: **3** **4**

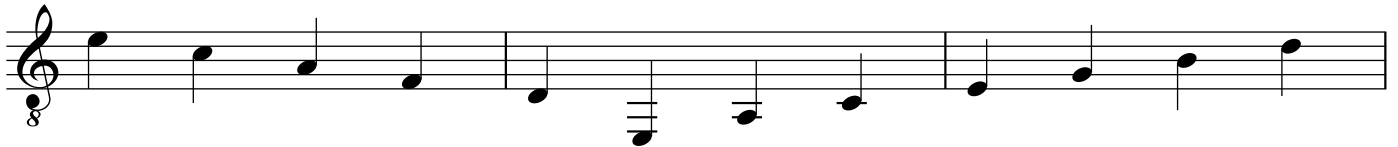
Note Review



Name: **C** **D**

Fret: **3** **0**

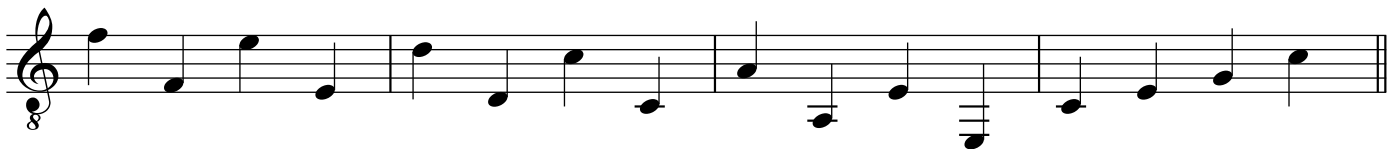
String: **5** **4**



Name:

Fret:

String:



Name:

Fret:

String:

Etude No. 8 - Prelude

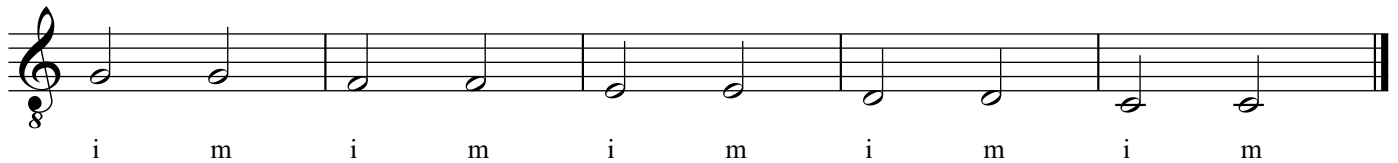
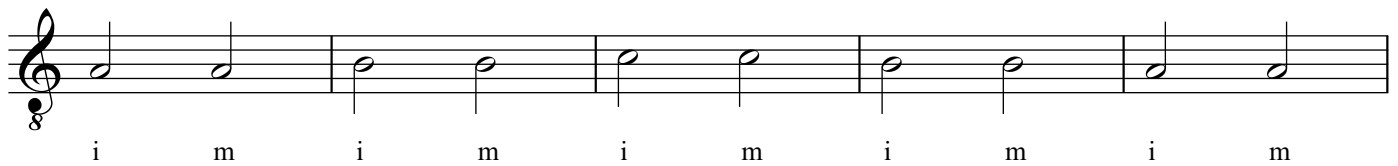
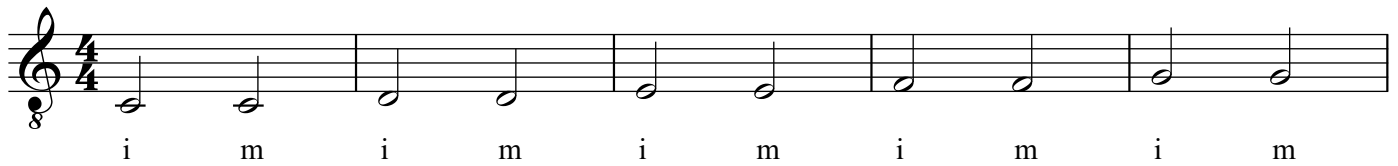
Hold fingers down and let notes sustain.

The sheet music for 'Etude No. 8 - Prelude' is written for guitar in 3/4 time. It consists of seven staves of music. The first staff includes fret numbers 3, 0, and 0 above the first three notes, and the letters 'p i m p i m' below the first six notes. The second staff has a fret number 0 above the first note. The third staff has a fret number 3 above the first note. The fourth staff has a fret number 0 above the first note. The fifth staff has a fret number 2 above the first note. The sixth staff has a fret number 0 above the first note. The seventh staff has fret numbers 3, 0, and 3 above the first, third, and fifth notes, respectively. The piece concludes with a half note and the instruction 'rit...'.

C Major Scale

This is a C major scale with repeated half notes.
You will learn more about major scales in my Volume 2 method.

Rest your thumb on the 6th string.
Use *i-m* alternation the entire time.
Memorize this scale and warm up with it everyday.



Eighth Notes

Notice that eighth notes are connected with *beams*.

Eighth notes are half the value of quarter notes.

Therefore, there are two eighth notes in every beat.

Exercise No. 1a

Count the written numbers and say "and" for the plus sign.



Exercise No. 1b

Only count the written numbers (do not say "and" between the quarter beats).



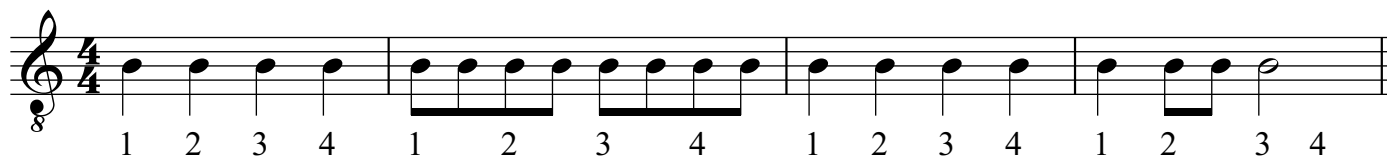
Exercise No. 2a

Count the written numbers and say "and" for the plus sign.



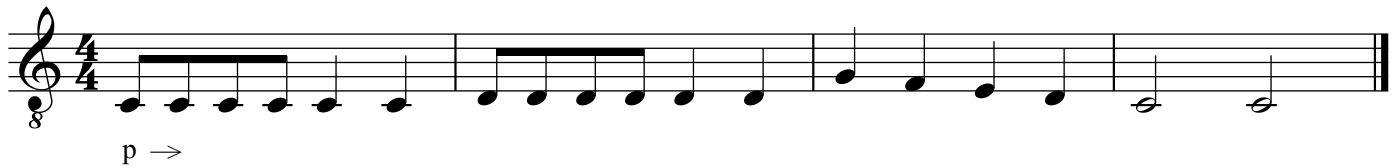
Exercise No. 2b

Only count the written numbers (do not say "and" between the quarter beats).

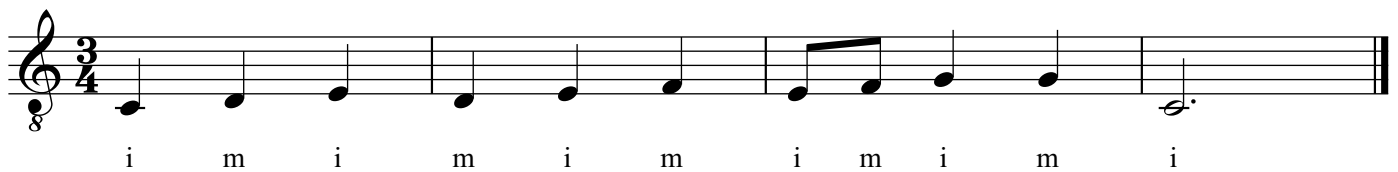


Sight Reading

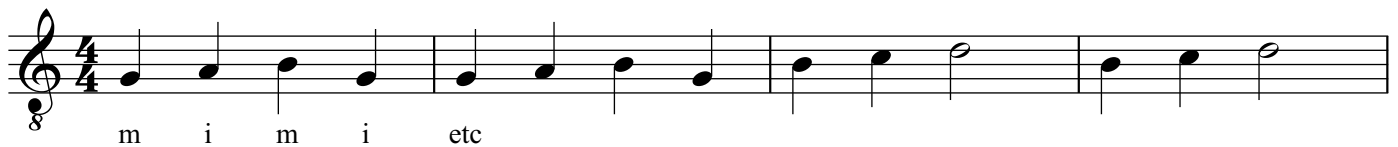
Exercise 1 - Count 1-2-3-4 as you play. Use your right hand thumb the entire time.



Exercise 2 - Count 1-2-3 out loud as you play. Use *i-m* the entire time.



Frère Jacques



Merrily we roll along

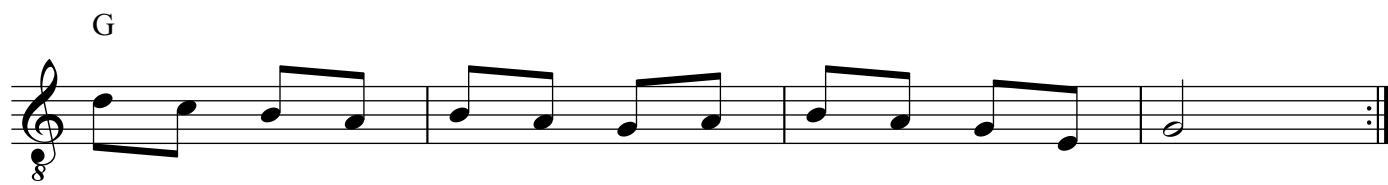
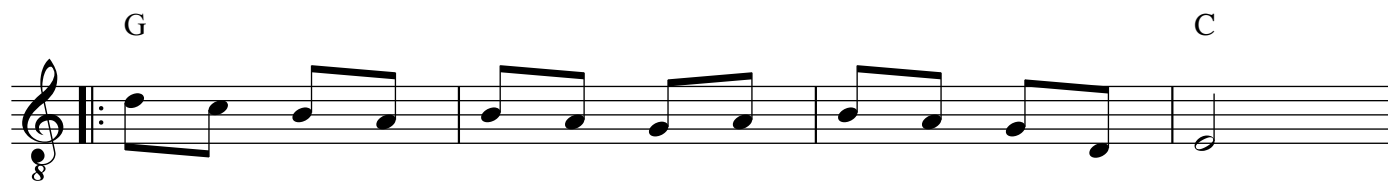
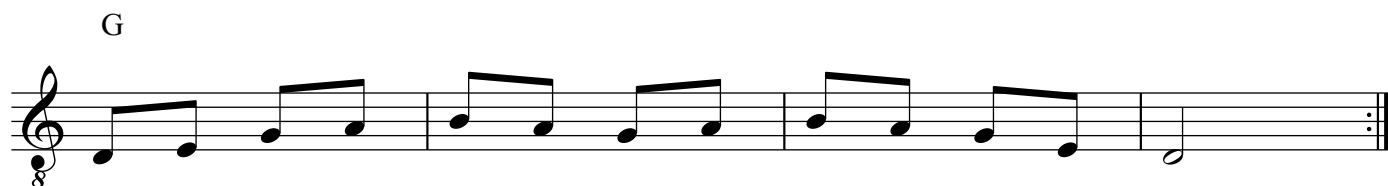
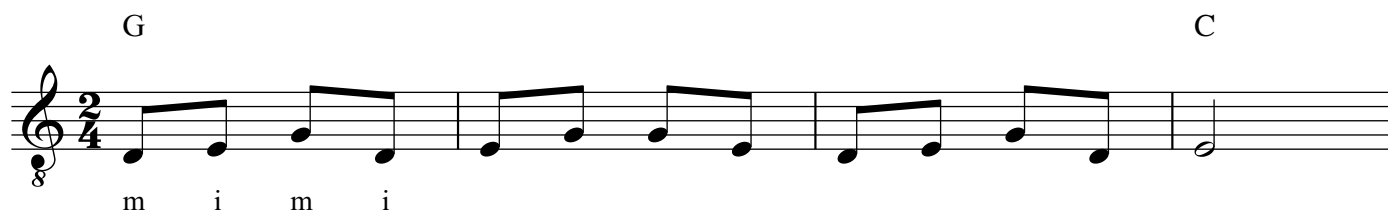
Notice the time signature indicates two beats per bar (count 1-2 for each bar).



Angeline the Baker

Traditional Bluegrass
Fiddle & Banjo Tune

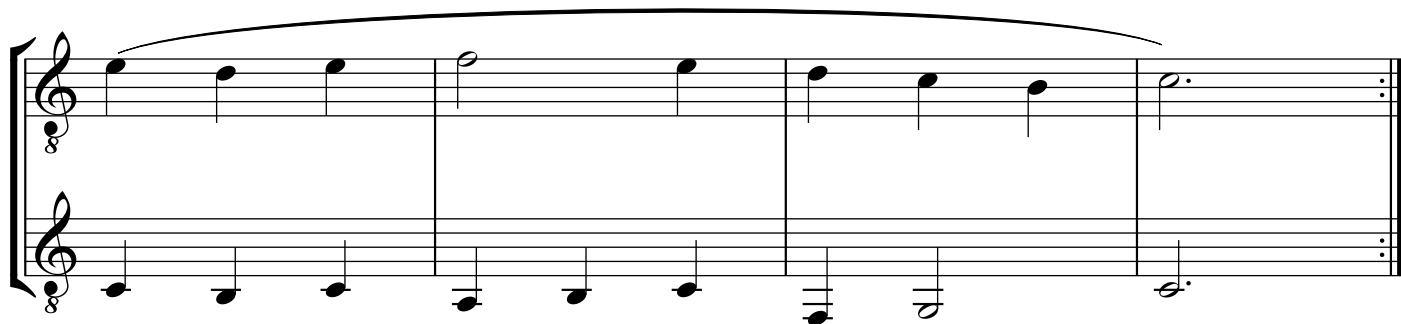
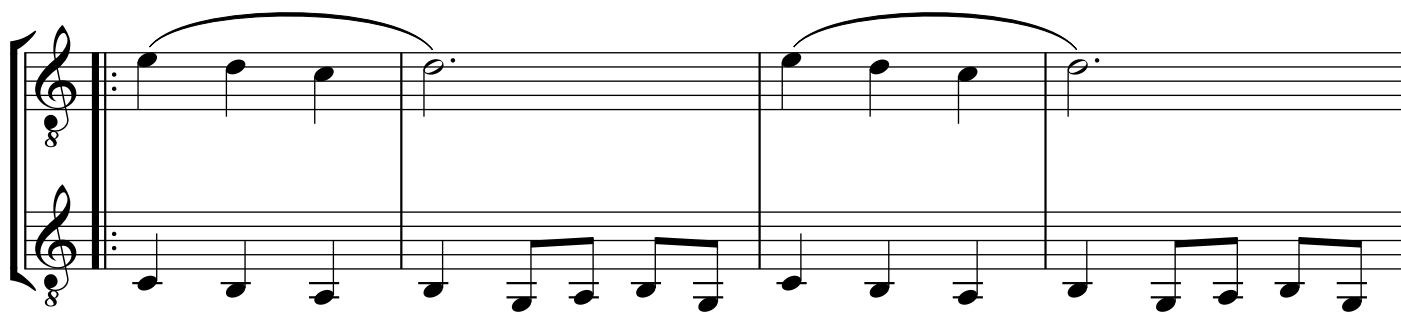
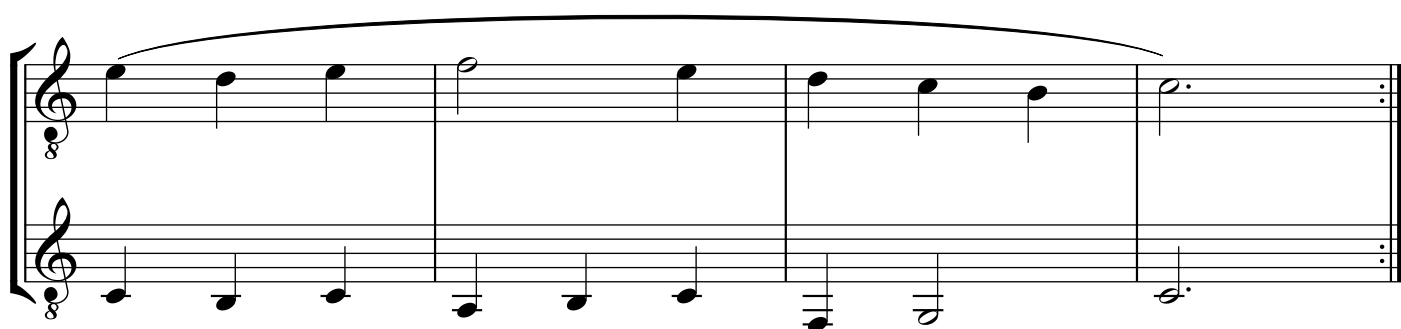
Play the melody with alternating *i-m* fingering.



Minuet

The student plays the top part as a solo or duet.

James Hook
(1746-1827)
Edited for this book.



Etude No. 9 - Glass

Let all notes sustain.

8 p i m i p i m i

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Vsi so venci vejli

(All the Wreaths are White)

Traditional Slovenian
Transcribed by Uroš Barič

Thanks to Slovenian guitarist Uroš Barič for this beautiful song.
Play the notes slowly and legato aiming for the first beat of each bar.
The letters above the staff are chords for the teacher.

Notice the changing time signature and eighth notes.
When the time signature changes, count different numbers of beats for the bars.
I've written the beat under the music to help. Count out loud as you play.

Chords: C, F, G, C, G, C

Count: 1 2 3 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4

The first line of music is written on a treble clef staff with a key signature of one flat (Bb). It begins with a 3/4 time signature and changes to 4/4 after the second bar. The notes are: C4 (quarter), D4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), F4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), Bb4 (quarter), C5 (quarter), D5 (quarter), E5 (quarter), F5 (quarter), G5 (quarter), A5 (quarter), Bb5 (quarter), C6 (quarter). The counts are written below the staff: 1, 2, 3, 1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 2, 3, 4.

Chords: G, C, G, C, F, G, C

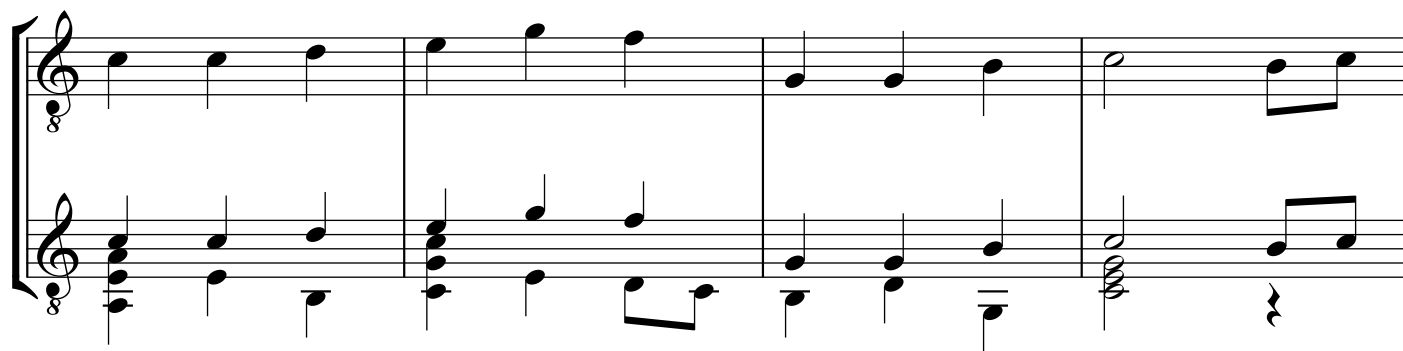
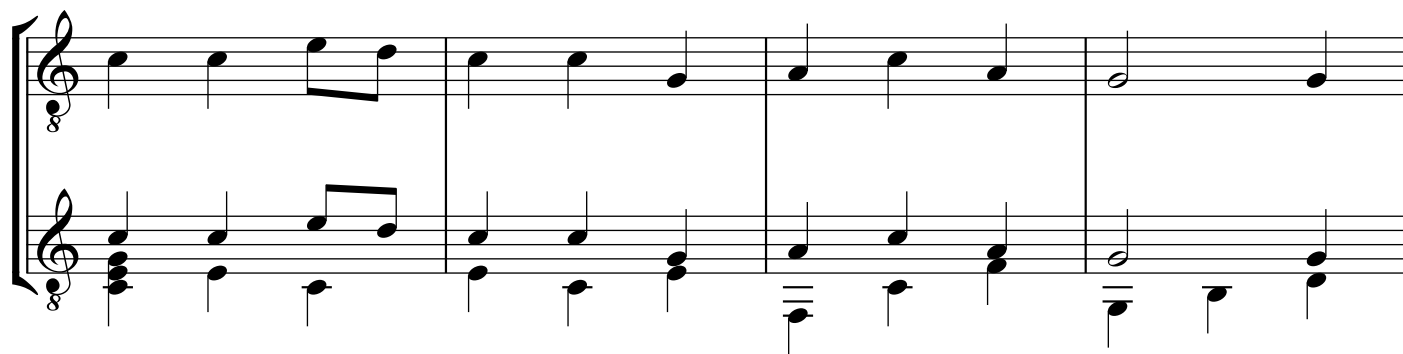
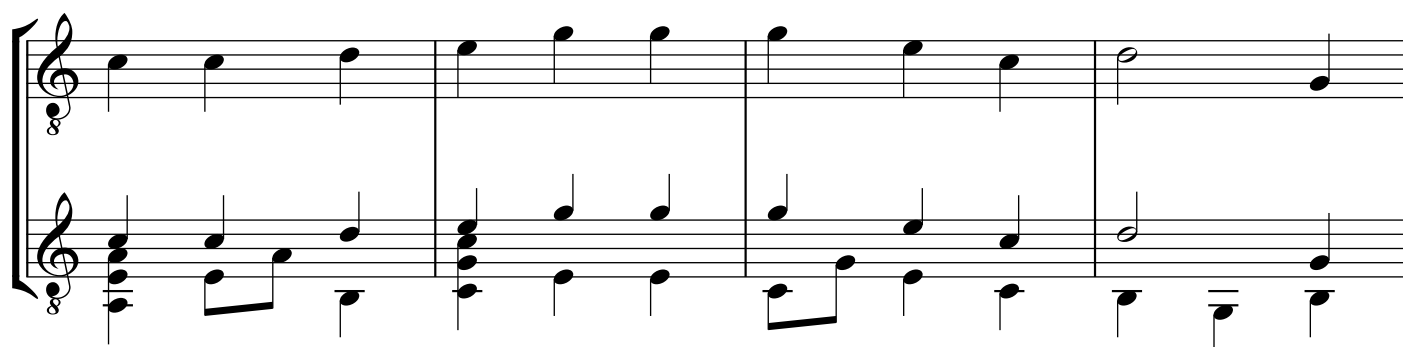
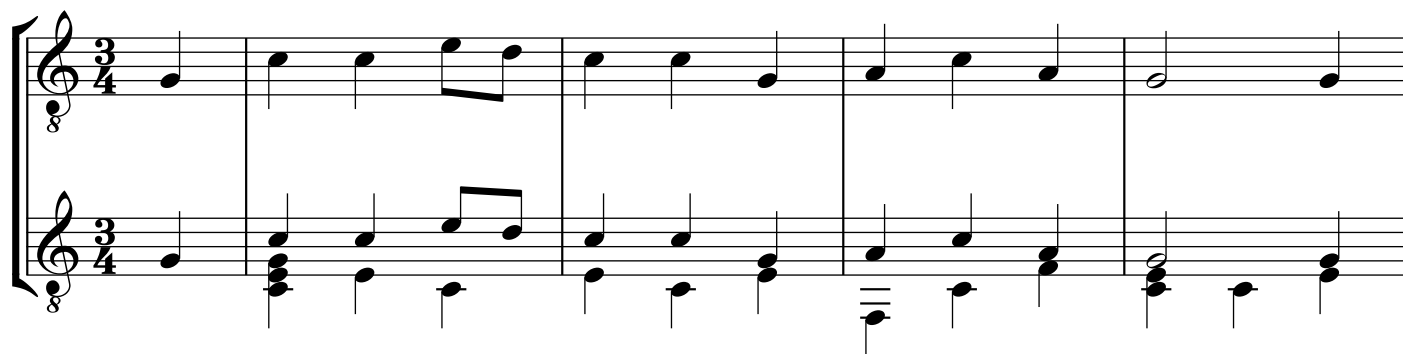
Count: 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 1 2 3

The second line of music continues on the same staff. It begins with a 4/4 time signature and changes to 3/4 after the fourth bar. The notes are: G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), Bb4 (quarter), C5 (quarter), D5 (quarter), E5 (quarter), F5 (quarter), G5 (quarter), A5 (quarter), Bb5 (quarter), C6 (quarter), D6 (quarter), E6 (quarter), F6 (quarter), G6 (quarter), A6 (quarter), Bb6 (quarter), C7 (quarter). The counts are written below the staff: 1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 2, 3, 1, 2, 3.

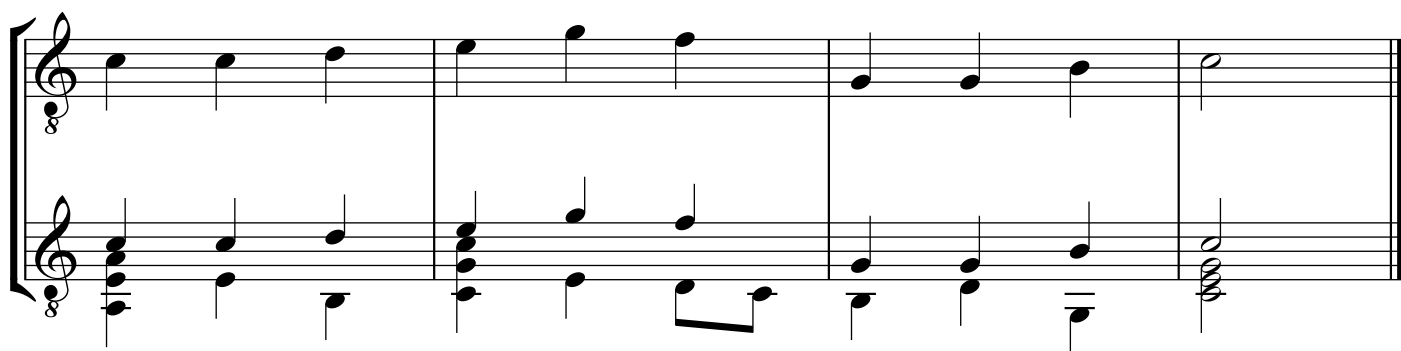
Flow Gently, Sweet Afton

Scottish
Folk Song

The student plays the top part as a solo or duet.
The melody is in both parts, phrase together.



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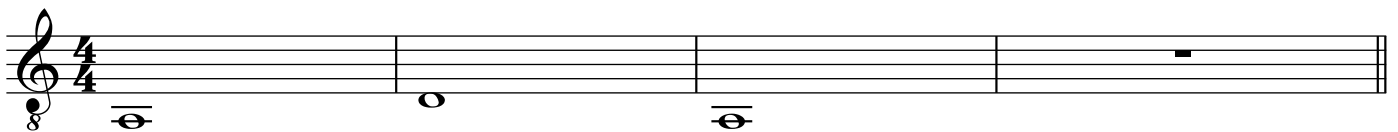
Two Voice Textures

Multiple musical lines can be written and played simultaneously.
When two voices are written, each voice must account for all the beats in the bar.
This allows composers to write exactly how long each note should sustain.
Let's first look at the voices separately and then combine them into one staff.

Voice One (upper)

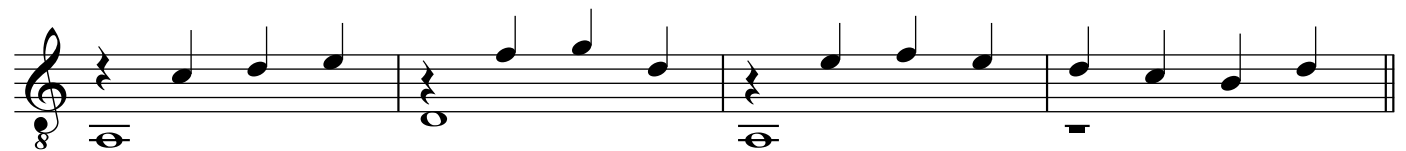


Voice Two (lower)



Both voices on the same staff (two-voice or two-part texture)

Notice how the rests in each voice account for all beats in the bar.



Count: 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4

Etude No. 10 - The Swan

Different stem directions help keep the voices separate.
Notice the special fingering needed to play legato from G to D.

The first system of the musical score for 'The Rose Tree' is shown. It consists of a treble clef and a bass clef. The treble clef has a key signature of one flat (B-flat) and a time signature of 8/8. The bass clef has a key signature of one flat (B-flat) and a time signature of 8/8. The melody is written in the treble clef and consists of the following notes: G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), C5 (quarter), B4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), F4 (quarter), E4 (half). The bass line is written in the bass clef and consists of the following notes: G3 (half), F3 (half), E3 (half), D3 (half), C3 (half), B2 (half), A2 (half), G2 (half). The system ends with a double bar line. Below the staff, there are dynamic markings: 'p' (piano) and 'm' (mezzo-forte). There are also fingerings: '4' and '3' above the notes B4 and A4 respectively. A 'd' (diminuendo) marking is placed below the staff, and a 'V' (crescendo) marking is placed below the staff.

Etude No. 11 - The Old Douglas Fir

Play the melody (stems up) on its own a few times before including the bass notes. Notice how two notes from separate voices are played at the same time in bar 8 and bar 16. Play all lower voice notes (stems down) with *p* and all upper voice notes (stems up) with *i-m*.

The image shows a musical score for a song in 3/4 time. The melody is written on a treble clef staff with a key signature of one flat (B-flat). The lyrics are 'i p m i p m'. The score is divided into four measures, each containing a melody line and a bass line. The first measure has a treble clef and a key signature of one flat. The second measure has a treble clef and a key signature of one flat. The third measure has a treble clef and a key signature of one flat. The fourth measure has a treble clef and a key signature of one flat. The lyrics are 'i p m i p m'.

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Dotted Quarter Notes

A dot after a note adds half of its value to its length.

A dotted quarter note equals one and a half beats.

$$\text{Dotted Quarter Note} = \text{Quarter Note} + \text{Eighth Note}$$

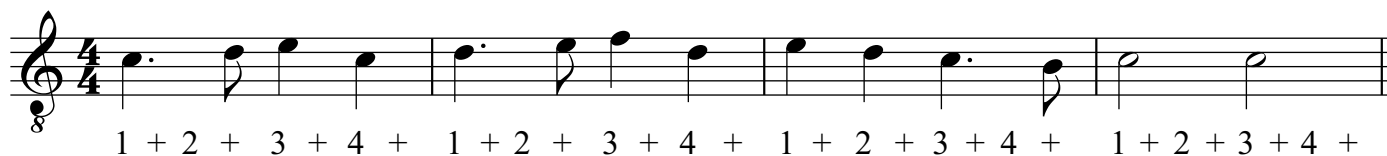
Exercise 1a - Deck the Halls. Count out loud as written (say the "and").



Exercise 1b - Deck the Halls. Count out loud as written (do not say "and")



Exercise 2a - Count out loud as written (say the "and")



Exercise 2b - Count out loud as written (do not say "and")



Во поле березка стояла

(Little Birch Tree in the Field)

Russian Folk Song

Thanks to my friends Natasha and Galina for recommend this song.
Notice the time signature for this piece has only two beats per bar.
Play all bass notes with *p* and all melody notes with *i-m*.
Do your best to alternate your right hand fingers.

The sheet music is written in 2/4 time. It consists of four staves. The first staff includes fingerings (i, m, i, m, i, m, i, m) and dynamics (p) for the bass line. The melody is written in the treble clef, and the bass line is in the bass clef.

The Skye Boat Song

Scottish Folk Song

The student plays the notes. The teacher accompanies with chords.

D.C. al Fine - Return to beginning and play until the *Fine*.

The musical score for "The Skye Boat Song" is written in 3/4 time and consists of six staves of music. The key signature is one flat (B-flat), and the time signature is 3/4. The score includes guitar-specific notation such as fingerings (3, 0, 3, 4) and a capo position (8). The chords are indicated above the staff lines.

Staff 1: Chords: C, Am, Dm, G, C. Fingerings: 3, 0, 3, 4.

Staff 2: Chords: F, C, G, C, Am.

Staff 3: Chords: Dm, G, C, F, C. Ends with **Fine**.

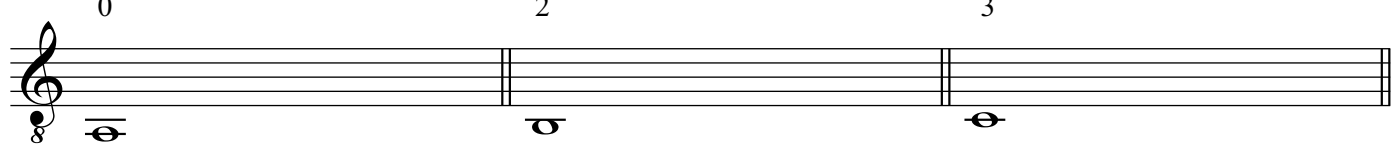
Staff 4: Chords: Am, Dm, Am.

Staff 5: Chords: F, Am, Am.

Staff 6: Chords: Dm, Am, F, Am, G. Ends with **D.C al Fine**.

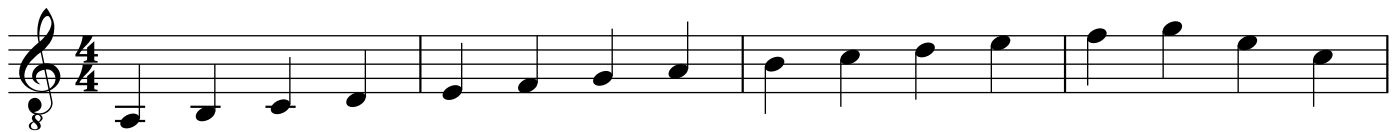
Fifth String Notes

A	B	C
0	2	3



5th string open	5th string 2nd fret 2nd finger	5th string 3rd fret 3rd finger
--------------------	--------------------------------------	--------------------------------------

Name the following notes



Name: **A** **B** **C**

Fret: **0** **2** **3**

String: **5** **5** **5**



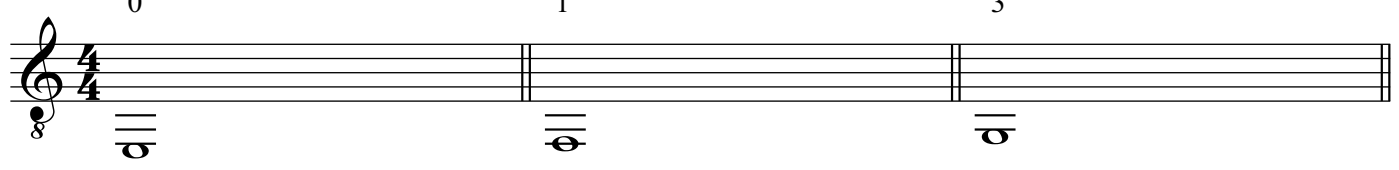
Name: **A** **F**

Fret: **2** **3**

String: **3** **4**

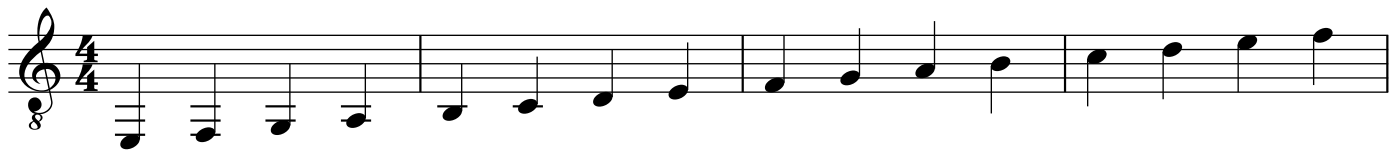
Sixth String Notes

E	F	G
0	1	3



6th string open	6th string 1st fret 1st finger	6th string 3rd fret 3rd finger
--------------------	--------------------------------------	--------------------------------------

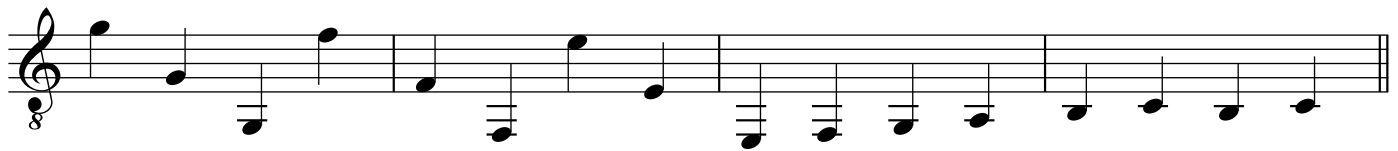
Name the following notes



Name: **E F G**

Fret: **0 1 3**

String: **6 6 6**



Name: **G G G**

Fret: **3 0 3**

String: **1 3 6**

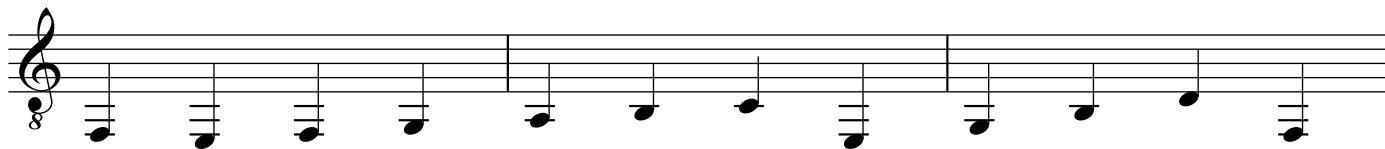
Note Naming



Name: **A** **B**

Fret: **0** **2**

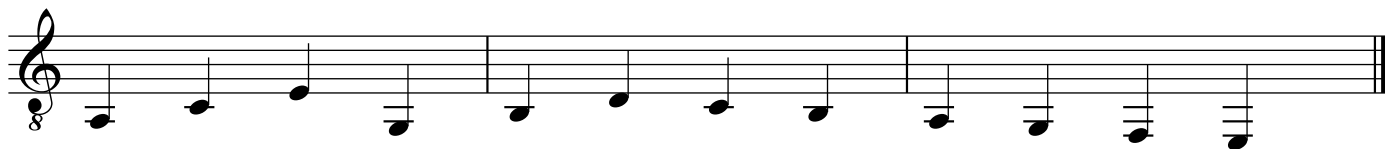
String: **5** **5**



Name:

Fret:

String:



Name:

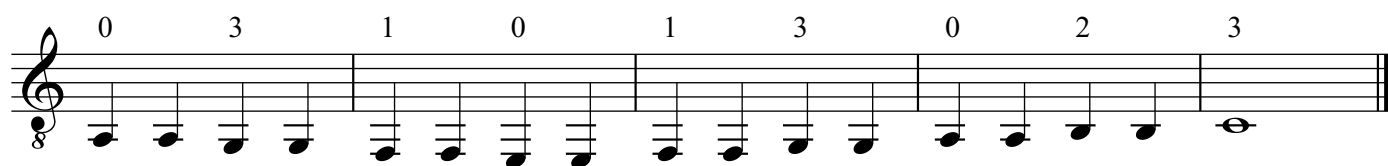
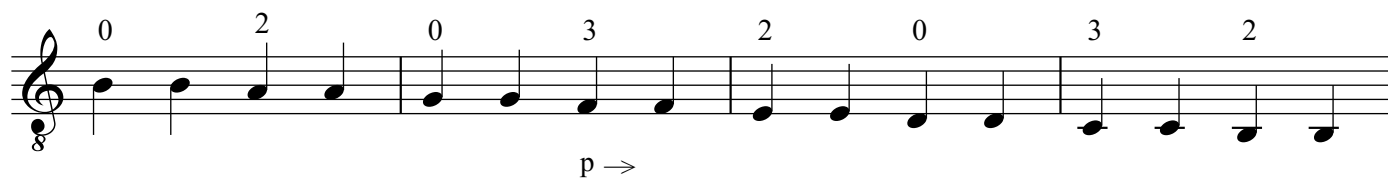
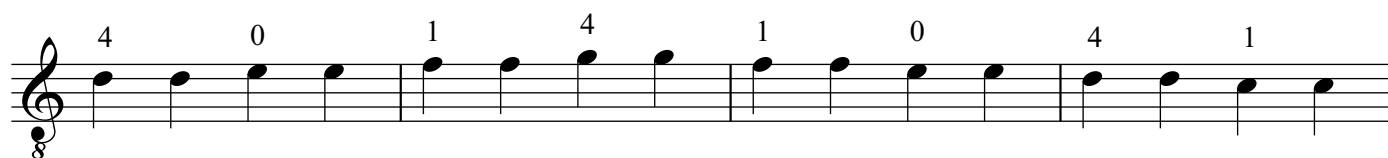
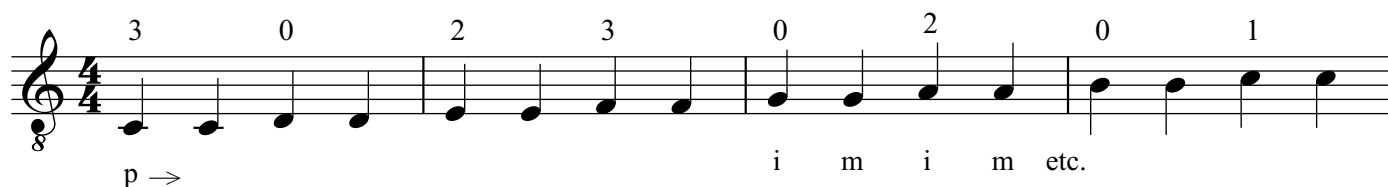
Fret:

String:

Note Review

Use you *p* on the three bass strings and *i-m* for the top three strings.
Say the note names out loud as you play.

For extra practice, try playing with all *i-m* alternation.

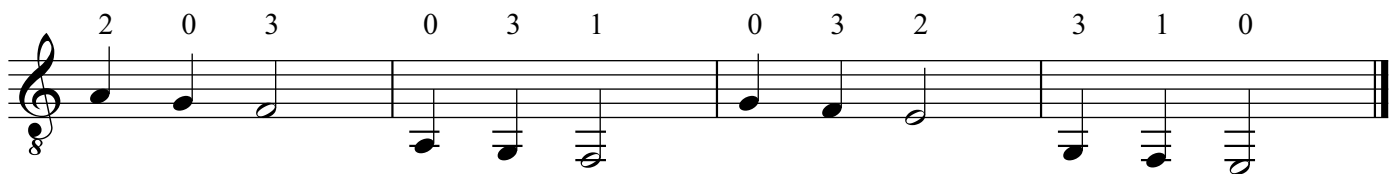
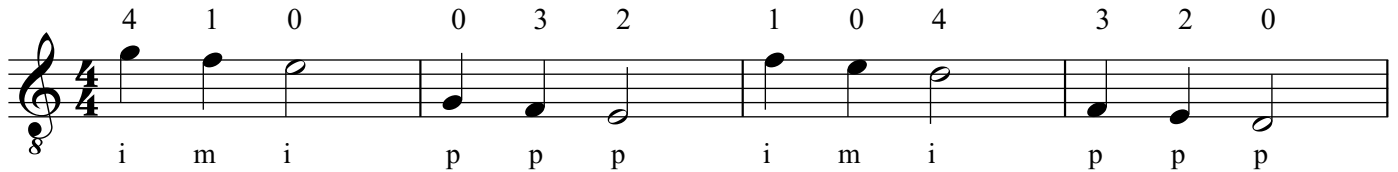


Sight Reading - The Imitation Game

Notice how every other bar is a repeat one octave lower (same note name but lower).

Use *i-m* for the upper octave and *p* for the lower octave as shown in the first line.

Say the note names out loud as you play.



Leyenda Theme

Isaac Albeniz
(1860-1909)

This piece is notated as one voice for simplicity. Let all notes sustain.
Notice the special fingering to play legato from E to B on the 4th and 5th string.
The time signature indicates six beats per bar.

6/4

p m p m p m

Accidentals

Sharps raise the pitch by a half-step (up one fret).

b Flats lower the pitch by a half-step (down one fret).

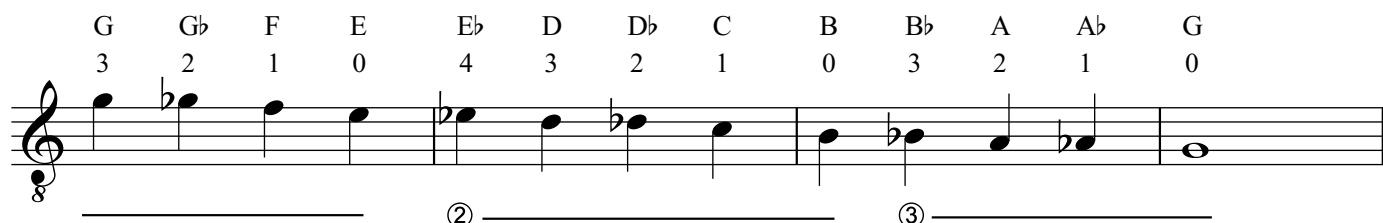
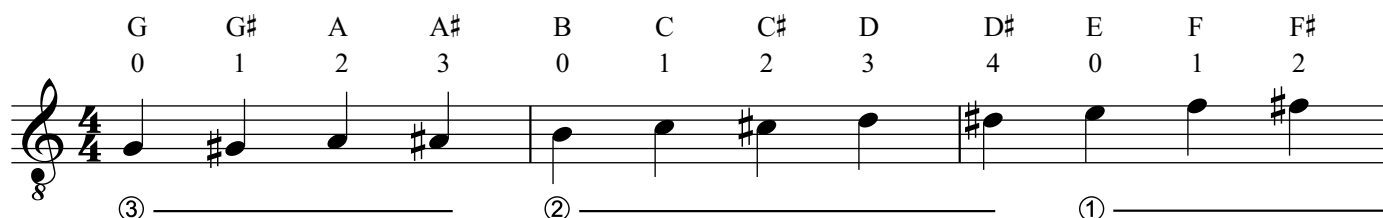
♮ Naturals return the note to its regular pitch.

G Chromatic Scale

In the below scale each new string is marked with a string number with a circle around it.

The fingering matches the fret number for this scale so use your third finger on D and G.

When flats are used on open string notes the flat note must be found on an adjacent string.



The Musical Alphabet

There are 12 notes in the traditional musical alphabet. Some notes have two different names but share the same pitch (sound), these are called *enharmonic notes* (indicted with slash marks).

Musical Alphabet: A A#/Bb B C C#/Db D D#/Eb E F F#/Gb G G#/Ab A

With Sharps: A A# B C C# D D# E F F# G G# A

With Flats: A Bb B C Db D Eb E F Gb G Ab A

E Chromatic Scale

This E chromatic scale goes up to the highest note in first position.
The pitches are the same ascending and descending but are spelled with sharps on the way up and flats on the way down. Say the note names out loud as you play.

The musical notation for the E Chromatic Scale in first position is presented in five systems, each on a single staff with a treble clef and a key signature of one sharp (F#). The scale is written in 4/4 time, with a common 8-measure bar line. Fingerings are indicated by numbers 0-4 above the notes. Practice lines are shown below the staff, with circled numbers indicating the starting fret for each run.

System 1: Ascending scale from E2 to A2. Notes: E2 (0), F2 (1), F#2 (2), G2 (3), A2 (4). Descending scale from A2 to E2. Notes: A2 (0), G2 (1), F#2 (2), F2 (3), E2 (4). Practice lines: ⑥ —, ⑤ —, ④ —.

System 2: Ascending scale from B1 to D2. Notes: B1 (2), C2 (3), C#2 (4), D2 (0), E2 (1), F2 (2), F#2 (3), G2 (0), A2 (1), B2 (2), C2 (3), D2 (4). Descending scale from D2 to B1. Notes: D2 (0), C2 (1), B2 (2), A2 (3), G2 (0), F#2 (1), F2 (2), E2 (3), D2 (4). Practice lines: ③ —, ② —.

System 3: Ascending scale from E2 to A2. Notes: E2 (0), F2 (1), F#2 (2), G2 (3), A2 (4), B2 (3), C2 (2), D2 (1), E2 (0), F2 (4), G2 (3), A2 (2). Descending scale from A2 to E2. Notes: A2 (0), G2 (4), F#2 (3), F2 (2), E2 (1), D2 (0), C2 (4), B2 (3), A2 (2). Practice lines: ① —, ② —.

System 4: Ascending scale from B1 to D2. Notes: B1 (1), C2 (0), C#2 (3), D2 (2), E2 (1), F2 (0), G2 (4), A2 (3), B2 (2), C2 (1), D2 (0), E2 (4). Descending scale from D2 to B1. Notes: D2 (0), C2 (4), B2 (3), A2 (2), G2 (1), F#2 (0), F2 (4), E2 (3), D2 (2), C2 (1), B2 (0), A2 (4). Practice lines: ③ —, ④ —, ⑤ —.

System 5: Ascending scale from E2 to A2. Notes: E2 (3), F2 (2), F#2 (1), G2 (0), A2 (4), B2 (3), C2 (2), D2 (1), E2 (0). Descending scale from A2 to E2. Notes: A2 (0), G2 (4), F#2 (3), F2 (2), E2 (1), D2 (0), C2 (4), B2 (3), A2 (2). Practice lines: ⑥ —.

Greensleeves

Traditional

The student plays the notes. The teacher accompanies with chords.
Accidentals (sharps and flats) apply to the entire bar. For example, the G#
in the first bar of the third line also applies to the G on the final beat of that bar.

Do your best to alternate *i-m* fingering but don't be too hard on yourself.
Practice alternating, remind yourself to do it, but never get frustrated if
you make small mistakes.

Am G Am

E Am G Am

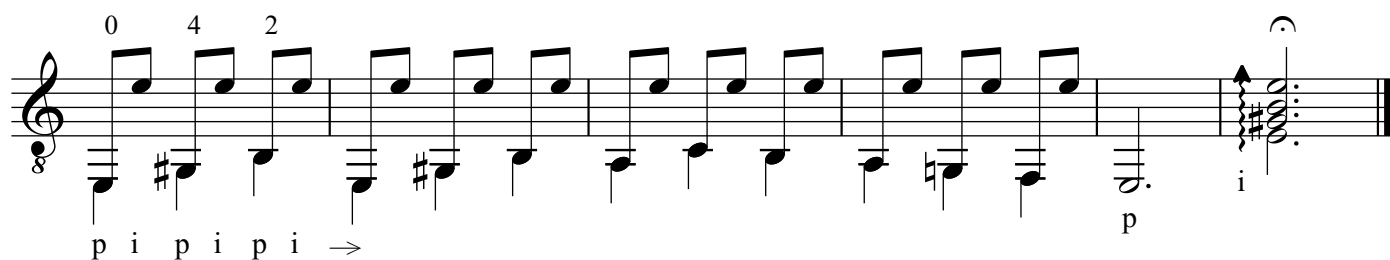
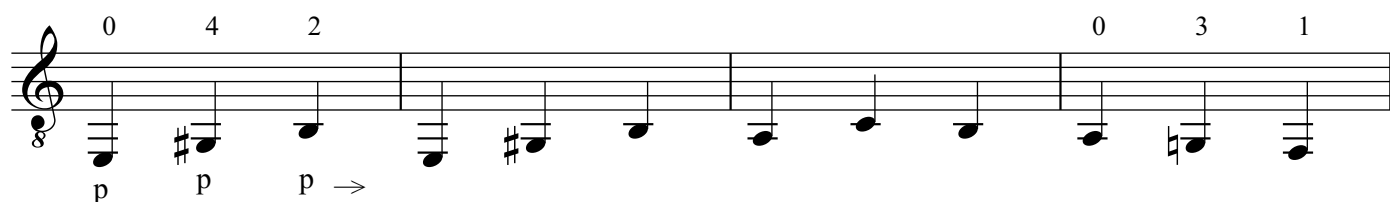
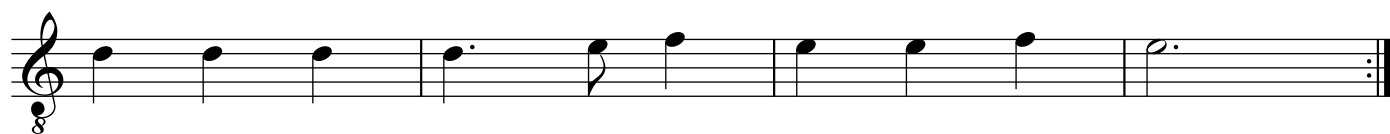
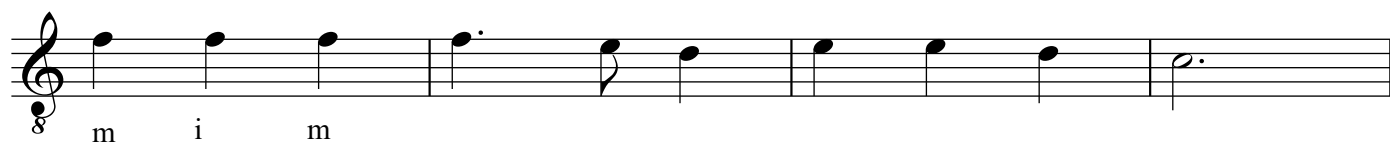
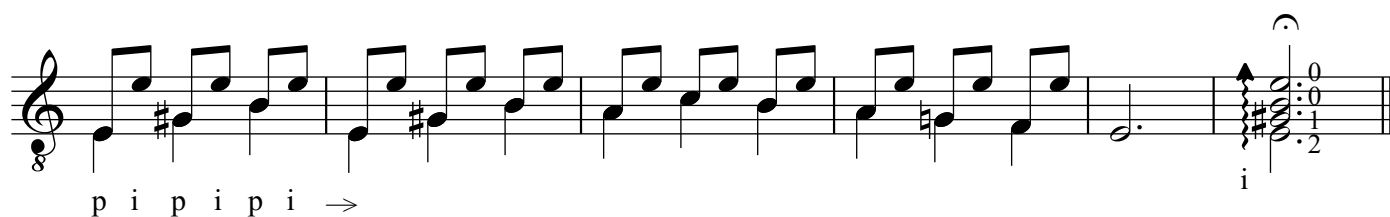
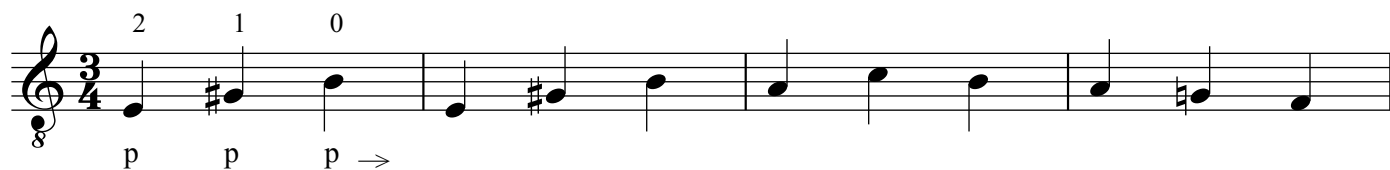
E Am C G

Am E C

G Am E Am

Malagueñas

The *malagueña* is a style of flamenco music derived from earlier types of the *fandango*. It is often improvised upon and is generally free in its rhythmic interpretation (*cante libre*). The vertical arrow at the end of the second line indicates a strum of the chord (*rasgueado*) using the fingernail of the top side of the *i* finger.



Minuet in G

Christian Petzold (1677-1733)
(First Section Only)

The student should practice both parts separately.
If played as a duet, switch parts at the repeat.

The first system of musical notation for the Minuet in G. It consists of two staves. The upper staff is in treble clef with a key signature of one sharp (F#) and a 3/4 time signature. It contains four measures of music. The lower staff is in bass clef with a key signature of one sharp (F#) and a 3/4 time signature. It contains four measures of music. The first measure of the upper staff has a finger number '2' above the second measure. The first measure of the lower staff has a finger number '4' above the second measure.

The second system of musical notation for the Minuet in G. It consists of two staves. The upper staff is in treble clef with a key signature of one sharp (F#) and a 3/4 time signature. It contains four measures of music. The lower staff is in bass clef with a key signature of one sharp (F#) and a 3/4 time signature. It contains four measures of music. The first measure of the upper staff has a finger number '4' above the second measure.

The third system of musical notation for the Minuet in G. It consists of two staves. The upper staff is in treble clef with a key signature of one sharp (F#) and a 3/4 time signature. It contains four measures of music. The lower staff is in bass clef with a key signature of one sharp (F#) and a 3/4 time signature. It contains four measures of music. The first measure of the upper staff has a finger number '2' above the second measure.

The fourth system of musical notation for the Minuet in G. It consists of two staves. The upper staff is in treble clef with a key signature of one sharp (F#) and a 3/4 time signature. It contains four measures of music. The lower staff is in bass clef with a key signature of one sharp (F#) and a 3/4 time signature. It contains four measures of music. The first measure of the upper staff has a finger number '4' above the second measure.

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Siciliano

Matteo Carcassi
(1792-1853)

Ties join together the rhythm of two notes of the same pitch.
Sustain for the full value of both notes (but do not re-pluck the 2nd note).
This is an authentic piece by a guitar player and composer of the Classical era.

The musical score is written in 3/4 time on a single staff. It includes guitar-specific notation such as natural harmonics (indicated by a small '8' below the staff) and fingerings (indicated by letters 'i', 'm', 'p' below the notes). The piece consists of four lines of music. The first line includes a tie between two half notes, with the word 'Tie' written below the slur. The lyrics 'i m i m i p m i' are placed below the first line. The second line has lyrics 'i m i p m i' below it. The third line has lyrics 'i m i p m i' below it. The fourth line has lyrics 'i a m i' below it. The score ends with a double bar line.

i m i m i p m i

i m i p m i

i m i p m i

i a m i

Farewell

Congratulations! You've made it to the final classical guitar piece in the book. The rhythm used here is called *triplets*: three notes evenly spaced within one quarter note beat (indicated by the bracket).

The first note of each triplet group is the melody. Let all notes sustain.

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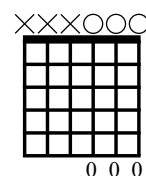
Chord Accompaniment Section

Before learning fingerstyle accompaniment some basic strumming patterns will be played.

Chord Diagrams

- Vertical lines = the strings
- Horizontal lines = the frets
- The string on the left is the 6th string (bass)
- Do not strum strings that have an X.
- The numbers below are the fingering.
- E minor = Strum the top three open strings
- Strum down from the 3rd to the 1st strings using your thumb or a pick.

E Minor (Em)



Hey, Ho, Nobody Home

- Strum four beats per bar as indicated by the slash marks (do not read the notes).
- Count out loud as you strum.
- The teacher plays or sings the melody.

Em

Hey, ho, no - bod - y home. Meat nor drink, nor

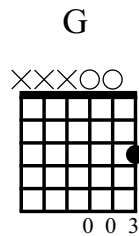
mon - ey have I none, yet will I be mer - ry.

Frère Jacques / Brother John

Traditional
France

The student strums a G Major chord the entire time (do not play the notes).
Strum four beats per bar (there are no slash marks anymore)
Once comfortable strum and sing the lyrics at the same time.

G Major Chord: 1st string, 3rd fret, 3rd finger. Strum the top three strings.



G

Frè - re Jac - ques, frè - re Jac - ques, dor - mez - vous? Dor - mez - vous?
Are you sleep - ing? Are you sleep - ing? Bro - ther John, Bro - ther John,

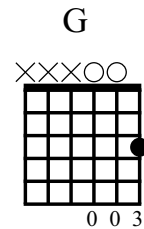
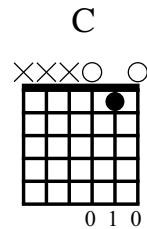
Son nez les ma - ti - nes! son-nez les ma - ti - nes! Ding, dang, dong. Ding, dang, dong.
Morning bells are ring - ing! Morning bells are ring - ing!

London Bridge

Traditional
England

The student strums the chords with four beats per bar and sings.
If no chord is shown, continue strumming the previous chord.

C Major: 2nd string, 1st fret, 1st finger. Strum the top three strings.



C G C

Lon - don Bridge is fal - ling down, fal - ling down, fal - ling down

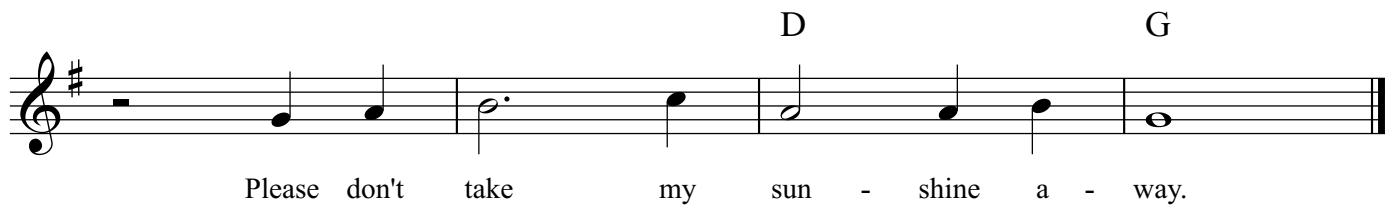
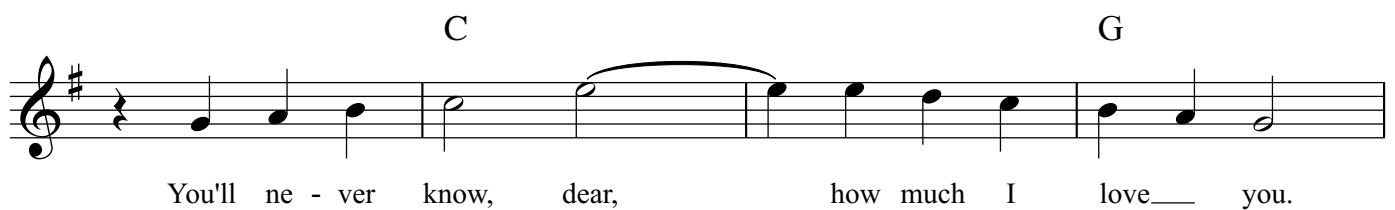
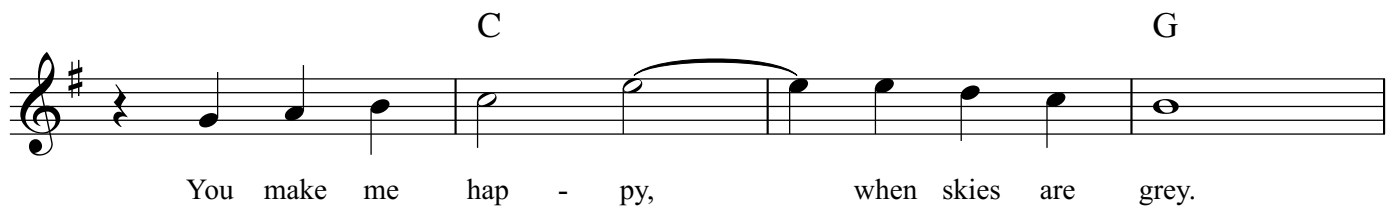
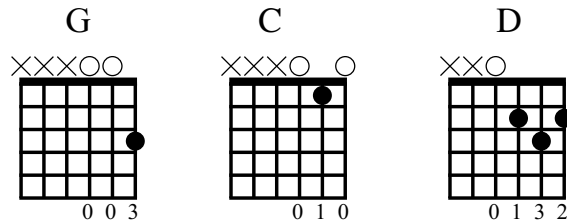
G C

Lon - don Bridge is fal - ling down, my fair la - dy

You Are My Sunshine

Jimmie Davis,
Charles Mitchell,
Paul Rice

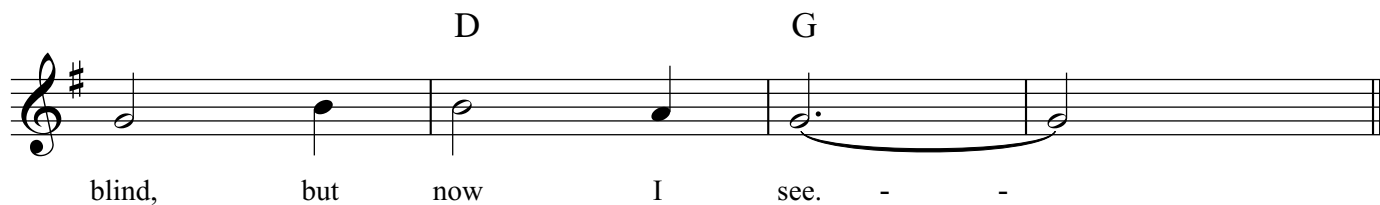
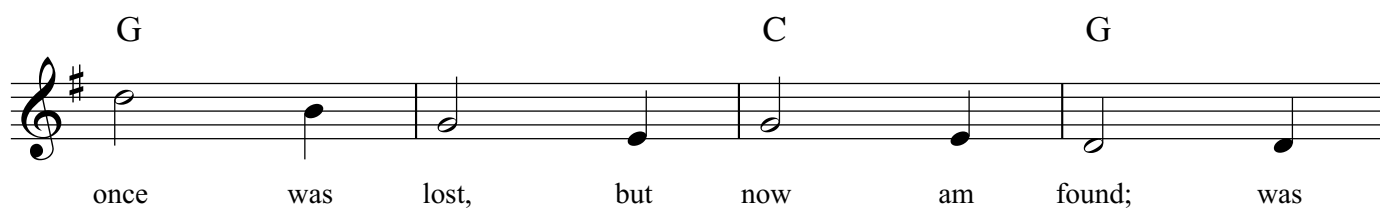
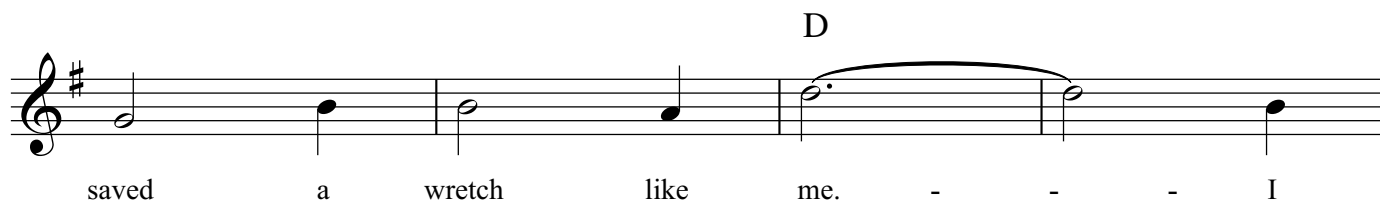
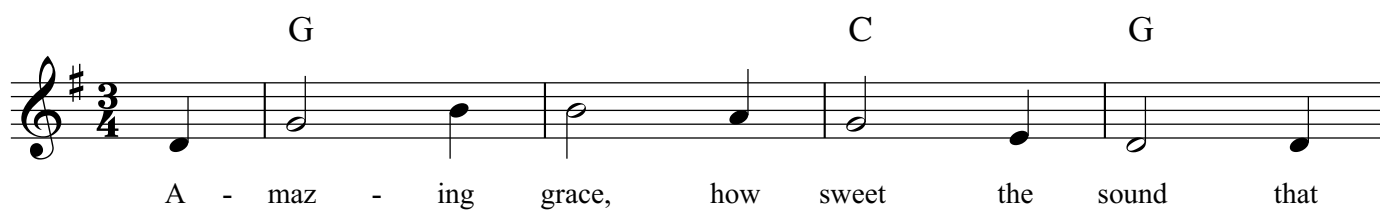
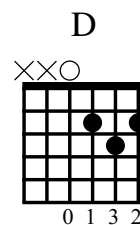
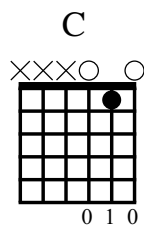
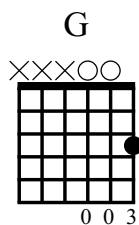
Strum the chords with four beats per bar.
Notice that the pickup bar starts on beat two.
D Chord - Follow the chord diagram and strum four strings.



Amazing Grace

Traditional Hymn

Strum the chords with three beats per bar.



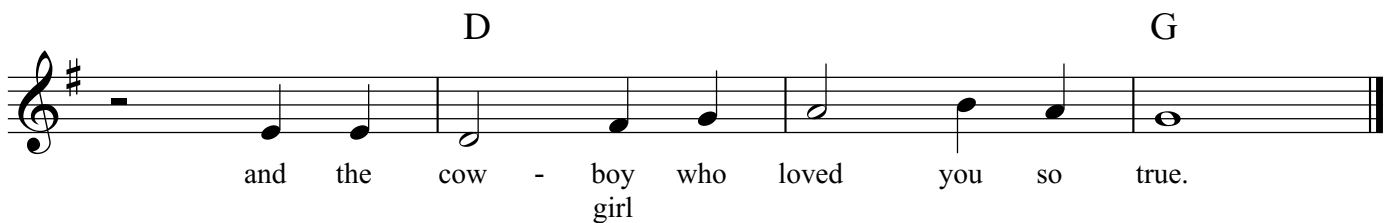
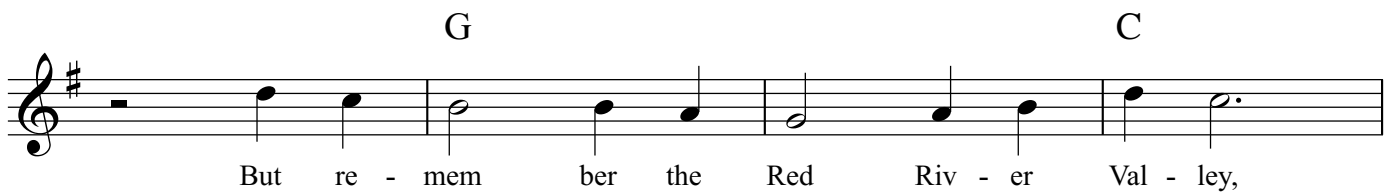
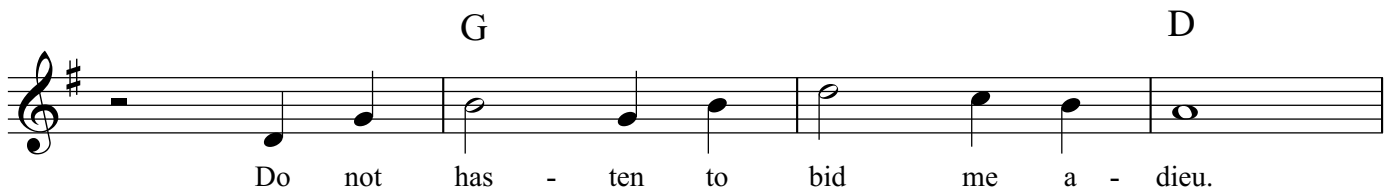
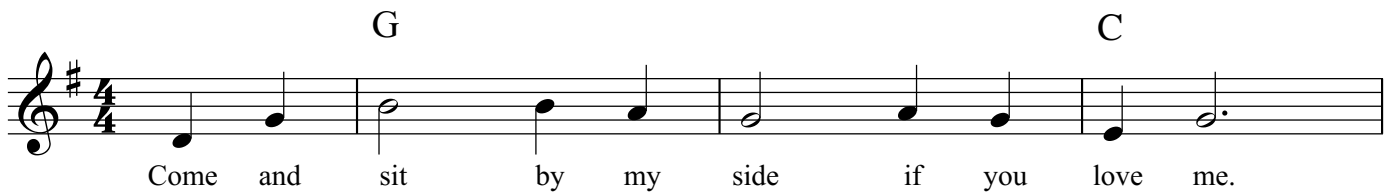
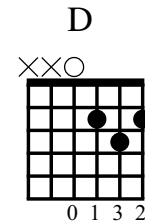
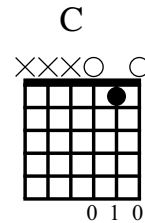
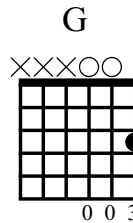
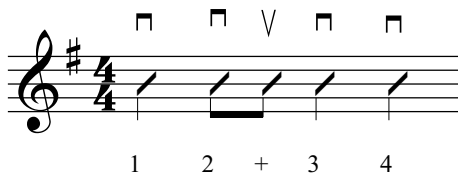
Red River Valley

Traditional
North American

Strum the chords using the below pattern (count four beats per bar).
Slightly swing/relax the eighth note.

Downstrum = ▢ Upstrum = ∇

Strum Pattern

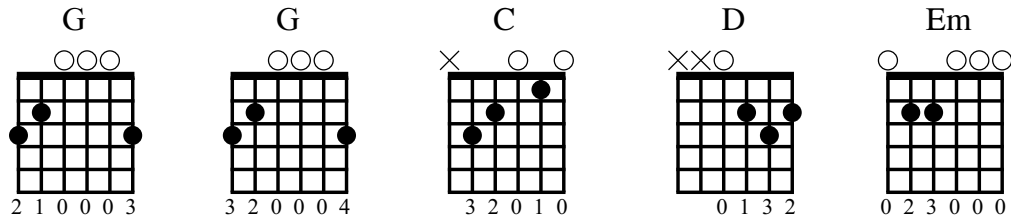


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Full Chord Shapes

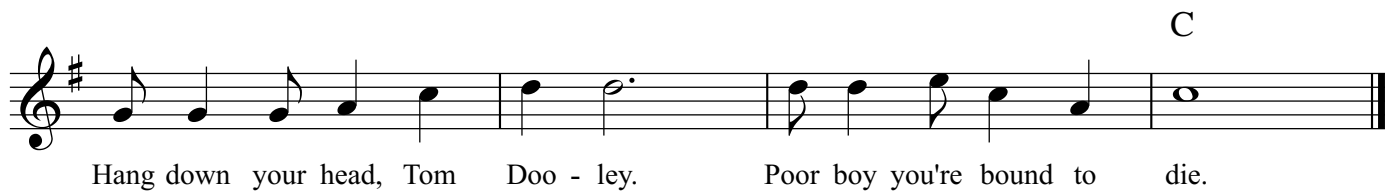
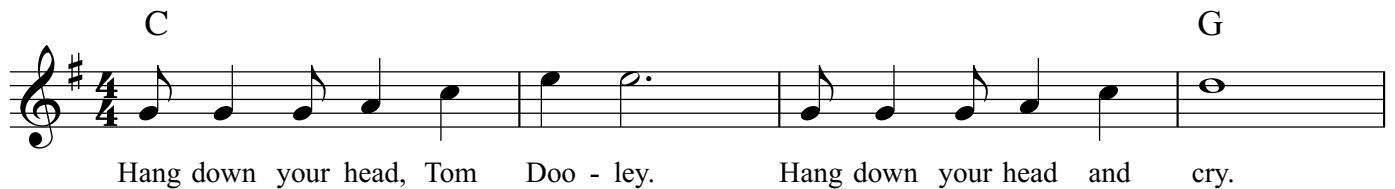
Memorize these chord shapes for the next few songs.

Notice the alternative fingering for the G chord. The first G chord is quite comfortable, the second is a bit of a stretch but easier to move to the C chord after. Practice both chord shapes. Youth students may have thier teacher choose one.



Tom Dooley - North Carolina Folk Song

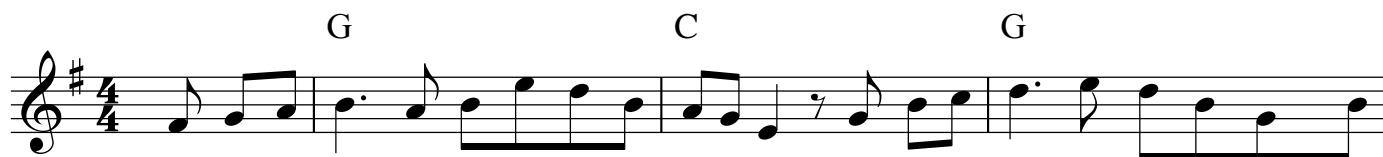
Try out the G and C chords by strumming four beats per bar.



Danny Boy

Traditional Irish

Bars containing two chords receive two beats per chord.



Oh, Dan-ny boy, - the pipes the pipes are call - ing, from glen to glen and down the moun-tain



side. The sum-mer's gone - and all the ros - es fall - ing. It's you, it's



you, must go, and I must bide. But come ye back when sum-mer's in the



mead - ow, or when the val - ley's hushed and white with snow. 'Tis I'll be



there in sun-shine or in shad - ow, oh, Dan-ny boy, oh, Dan-ny boy, I love you so!

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Shenandoah

American Folksong

The chords change more often in this song.
Pick a slow tempo to begin.

G C



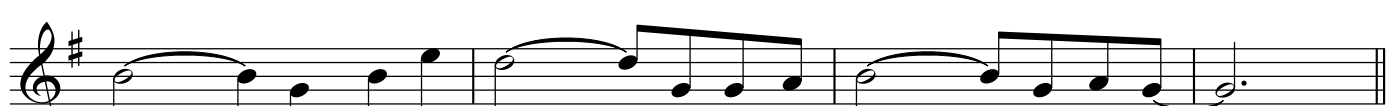
Oh. Shen-an- doah I long to see you, A - way you roll-ing

G C D Em C



riv - er, Oh Shen - an - doah I long to see you, A -

G C G Em G D G

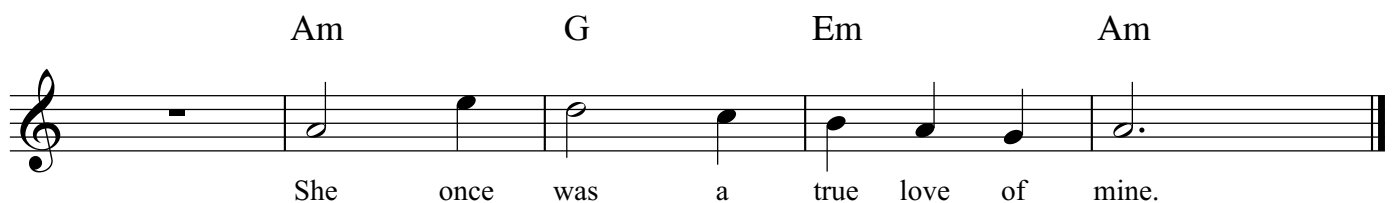
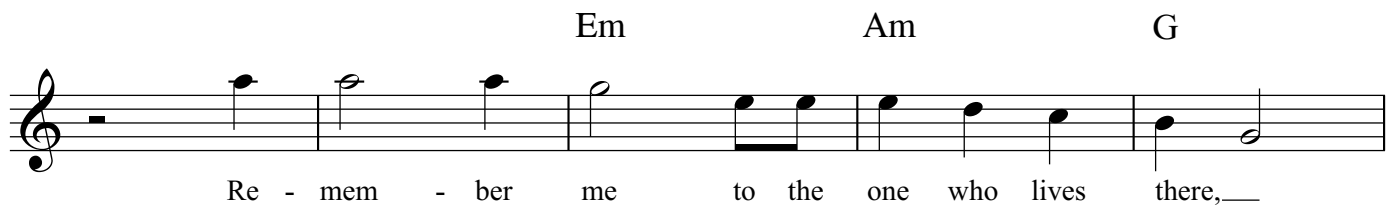
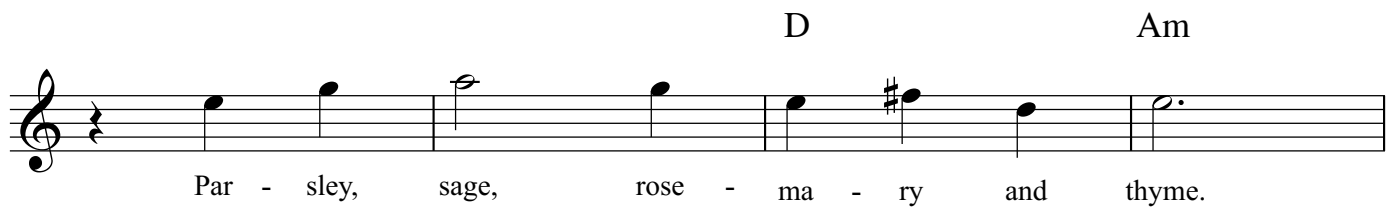
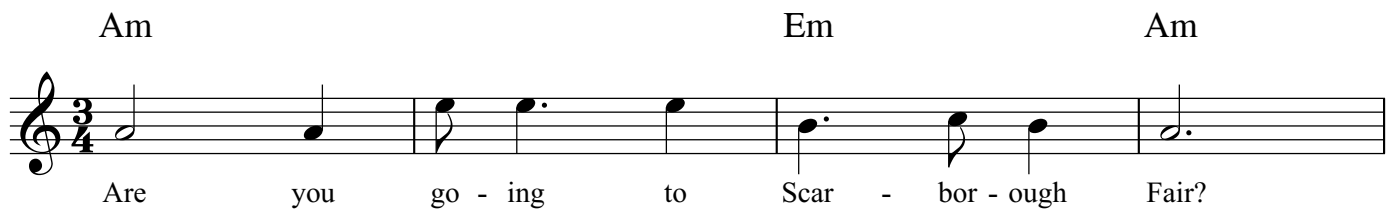
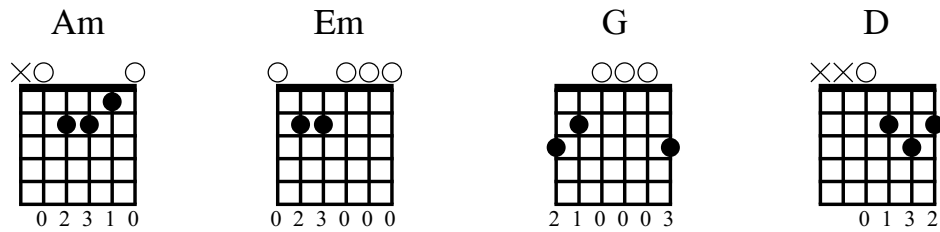


way we're bound a - way a-cross the wide Miss-ou - ri.

Scarborough Fair

Traditional

Strum with any strumming pattern as long as there are three beats per bar.
In the following pages we will also learn this song with fingerstyle accompaniment.



Tablature

Tablature (TAB) is another system of written music for guitar.
TAB is a visual representation of the six strings on the guitar.
The bottom line is the 6th string, the top line is the 1st string.
The numbers indicate the frets (not the fingering).

The below example demonstrates the same notes on both the notation staff and the TAB.

E E D B F D

0 0 0 2 3 3

6th string open 1st string open 4th string open 5th string 2nd fret 4th string 3rd fret 2nd string 3rd fret

Please Note

Tablature has been in use for centuries going back to the Renaissance lute. Modern TAB often omits rhythm and other musical indications so it has some clear disadvantages. Most importantly, it does not allow you to communicate with non-guitarists. However, it can still be useful for direct guitar knowledge and popular music can often be found in TAB.

Scarborough Fair (Fingerstyle)

Play the TAB as eighth notes (two notes for each beat).
When playing fingerstyle, only use the left hand fingers needed for each chord.
Let all notes sustain within each chord.

Am Em Am

Are you go-ing to Scar - bor-ough Fair?

p i m a m i p i m a m i p i m a m i (continue)

D Am

Par - sley, sage, rose - ma - ry and thyme.

Em Am G

Re - mem - ber me to the one who lives there,___

Am G Em Am

She once was a true love of mine.

Will the Circle Be Unbroken?

Ada R. Habershon &
Charles H. Gabriel

The student plays the TAB (4 beats per bar).
Notice the bassline contained in this fingerstyle accompaniment.
Use your thumb for the bass notes and i, m, a for the top three strings.

G

Will the cir - cle _____ be un - bro - ken, _____ by and

TAB

3 0 0 3 0 0 3 0 0 3 0 0 3 0 0 3 0 2

Detailed description: This system shows the first four measures of the song. The treble clef staff has a 4/4 time signature and a key signature of one sharp (F#). The melody starts on G4, moves to A4, then B4, and has a half note G4 tied to the next measure. The lyrics 'Will the cir - cle' are under the first measure, 'be un - bro - ken,' under the second, and 'by and' under the third. The guitar TAB below has four measures, each with a '3' indicating a triplet. The notes are: Measure 1 (0, 0, 0), Measure 2 (0, 0, 0), Measure 3 (0, 0, 0), and Measure 4 (0, 0, 2).

C G

by, _____ by and by? _____ Is a

TAB

0 0 0 0 3 3 3 3 0 0 0 0 3 3 3 3

1 1 1 1 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0

3 2 3 2 3 2 3 2 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0

Detailed description: This system shows measures 5-8. The treble clef staff has a whole note C5 in measure 5, followed by a half note G5 tied to measure 6, then a half note G5 tied to measure 7, and a half note G5 in measure 8. The lyrics 'by,' are under measure 5, 'by and by?' under measure 6, and 'Is a' under measure 7. The guitar TAB has four measures. Measures 5 and 6 have notes (0, 1, 0) and (0, 1, 0) respectively. Measures 7 and 8 have triplets of (0, 0, 0) and (0, 0, 0) respectively.

bet - ter _____ home a - wait - ing, _____ in the

TAB

3 3 3 3 3 3 3 3 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0

0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0

3 3 3 3 3 3 3 3 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0

Detailed description: This system shows measures 9-12. The treble clef staff has a half note G5 tied to measure 9, then a half note G5 tied to measure 10, a half note G5 tied to measure 11, and a half note G5 in measure 12. The lyrics 'bet - ter' are under measure 9, 'home a - wait - ing,' under measure 10, and 'in the' under measure 11. The guitar TAB has four measures, each with a triplet of (0, 0, 0).

D G

sky? _____ in the sky?

TAB

3 3 2 3 3 3 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0

0 0 3 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0

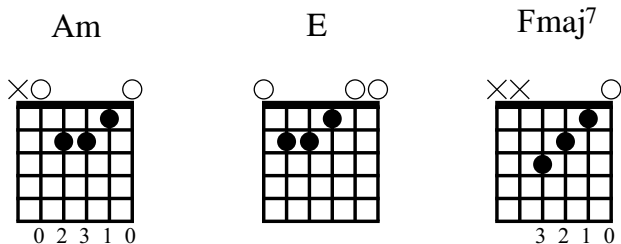
3 2 2 3 3 3 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0

Detailed description: This system shows measures 13-16. The treble clef staff has a whole note D5 in measure 13, followed by a half note G5 tied to measure 14, a half note G5 tied to measure 15, and a half note G5 in measure 16. The lyrics 'sky?' are under measure 13, and 'in the sky?' under measure 14. The guitar TAB has four measures. Measures 13 and 14 have notes (0, 0, 2) and (0, 0, 2) respectively. Measures 15 and 16 have triplets of (0, 0, 0) and (0, 0, 0) respectively.

Saint James Infirmary Blues

American Folksong

The student should first strum the chords and then invent a simple fingerstyle accompaniment.



Am E Am E Am E Am Fmaj⁷

4/4

E Am E 1. Am Fmaj⁷ E Am



2.

Am Fmaj⁷ E Am

The musical notation for the second ending is written on a single staff in treble clef. It consists of four measures. The first measure contains a half note G4 and a half note A4. The second measure contains a half note B4 and a half note C5. The third measure contains a half note D5 and a half note E5. The fourth measure contains a half note F5 and a half note G5. The notes are beamed together in pairs. The key signature is one flat (Bb), and the time signature is 4/4.

House of the Rising Sun

American
Folksong

Strum the chords and then learn the TAB. Play the TAB as triplets (three notes to each beat) as indicted in the first bar.

Am C D Fmaj⁷ Am C

p i m a m i p i m a m i (continue)

E Am C D Fmaj⁷

There is a house in New Orleans they

Am C E Am C

call the Rising Sun. It's been the ruin of

D Fmaj⁷ Am E Am

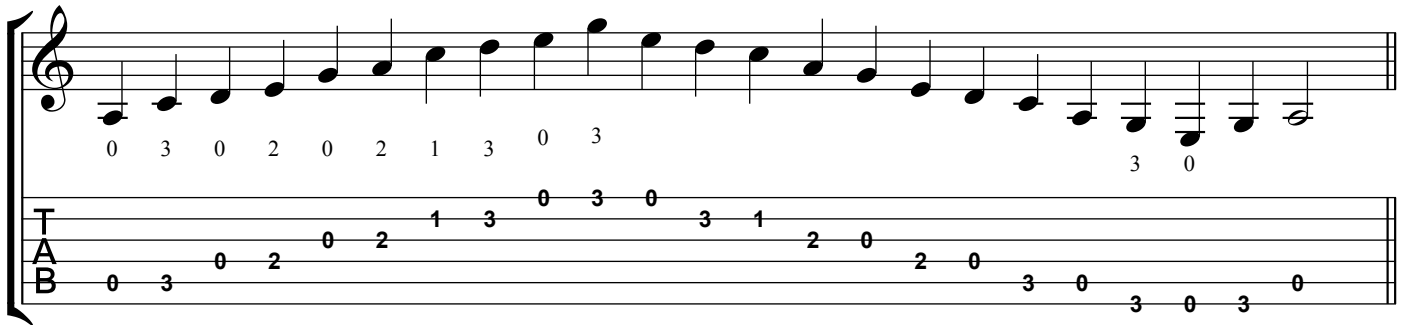
many poor gal, and I oh Lord was one.

Scales for Blues and Popular Music

Below is the pentatonic minor and blues scales up to the highest notes in position.

These can be used for soloing over the following blues chords and other chord progressions such as House of the Rising Sun.

A Pentatonic Minor (open position)



Twelve Bar Blues

Use the TAB to check your note locations.
Take a solo using the A pentatonic minor scale.
When finished repeating, end using the A chord instead of E.
Swing the beat (think: long-short-long-short).

[illegible][illegible]

1 0

2 0 2 0 2 0 2 0

2 0 2 0 2 0 2 0

2 0 2 0 2 0 2 0

The Shuffle

[illegible]

D A

1 0 3 0

TAB

2 2 4 4 2 2 4 4 2 2 4 4 2 2 4 4 2 2 4 4

0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0 0

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Rhythm Riff Blues

A

T
A
B

D

A

T
A
B

E

D

A

(E)

T
A
B

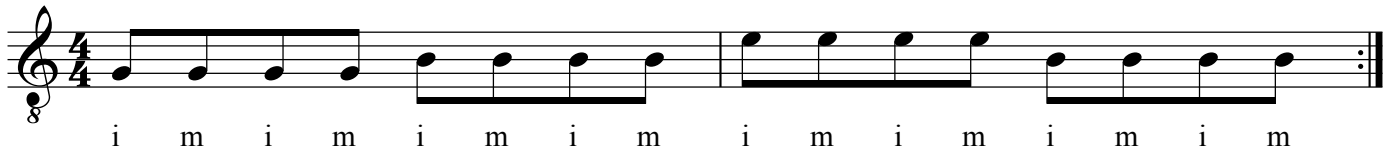
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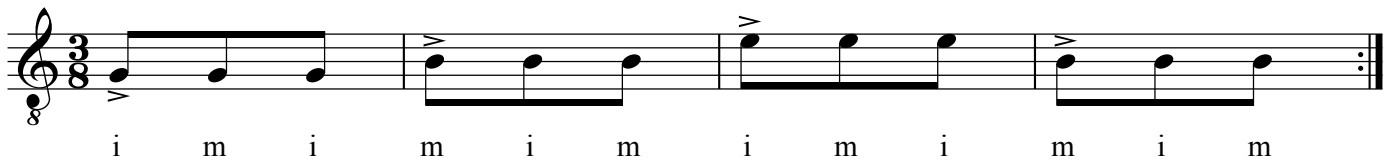
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Right Hand Technique Routine

No. 1 - i, m alternation in groups of four



No. 2 - i, m alternation in groups of three

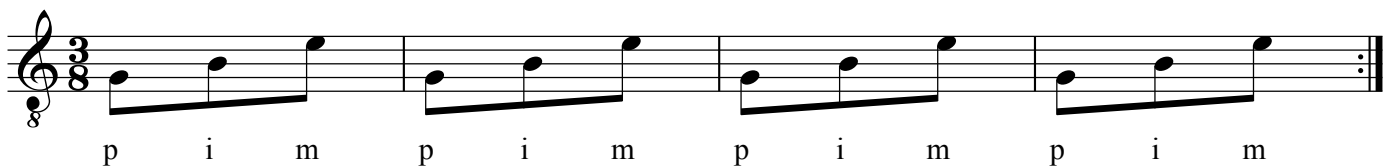


No. 3 - p, i alternation

Remember to keep the thumb in front of the fingers during arpeggios. Checking your guitar position may help.



No. 4 - p, i, m arpeggio pattern

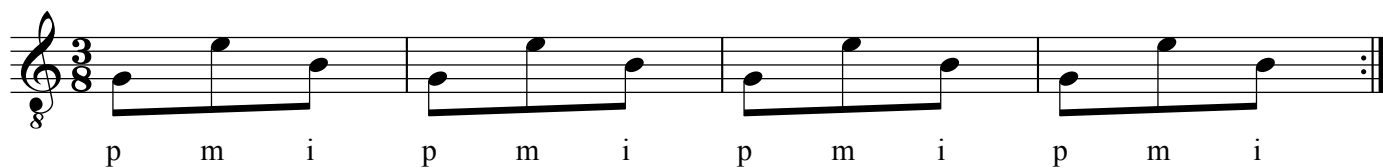


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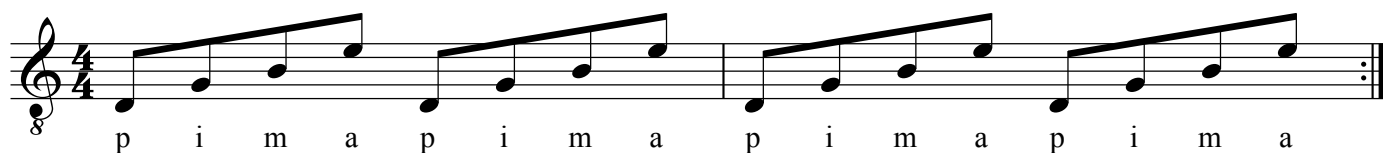
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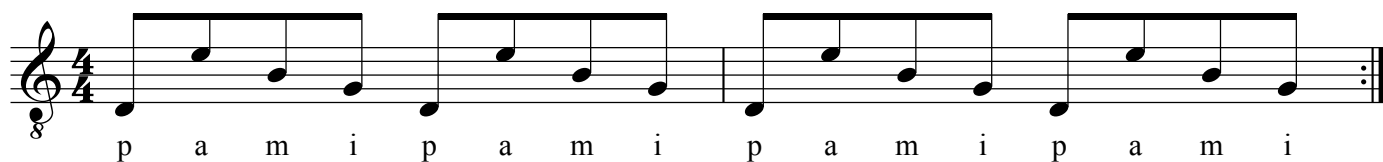
No. 5 - p, m, i arpeggio pattern



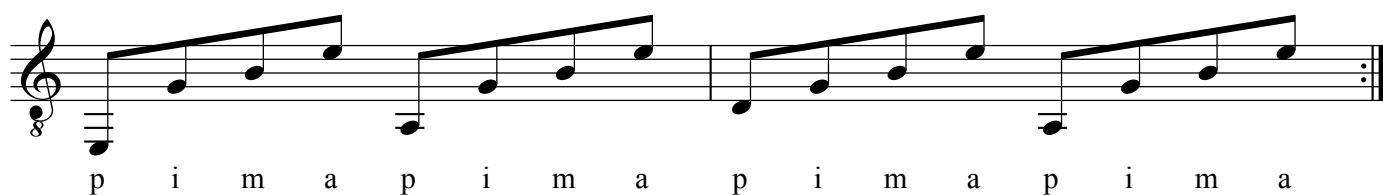
No. 6 - p, i, m, a arpeggio pattern



No. 7 - p, a, m, i arpeggio pattern



No. 8 - p, i, m, a bass strings arpeggio pattern



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Left Hand Technique Routine

Tablature has been included to clarify the upper position playing.
These exercises use the one-finger-per-fret rule or one finger after the other.

Keep the left hand palm and knuckles aligned with the strings.

Play on your fingertips and curve each joint of each finger.

Use your right hand thumb for the bass strings and *i-m* for the top three strings.

No. 1 - Fingers 1-2-3-4 on all strings

Start at the 5th fret on the 6th string and play one left hand finger after the other.

Exercise No. 1 is a left-hand technique exercise in 4/4 time. It consists of six measures, each containing four notes. The notes are played on the 6th, 5th, 4th, 3rd, 2nd, and 1st strings, respectively. The fret numbers for each note are 5, 6, 7, and 8. The fingers used for each note are 1, 2, 3, and 4, respectively. The exercise is designed to be played on the 6th string, 5th fret, and the notes are played one finger after the other.

No. 2 - Fingers 1 and 4 on all strings

Start at the 5th fret, 6th string, 1st finger and play with only fingers 1 and 4.

Observe the one-finger-per-fret rule.

Exercise No. 2 is a left-hand technique exercise in 4/4 time. It consists of six measures, each containing two notes. The notes are played on the 6th, 5th, 4th, 3rd, 2nd, and 1st strings, respectively. The fret numbers for each note are 5 and 8. The fingers used for each note are 1 and 4, respectively. The exercise is designed to be played on the 6th string, 5th fret, and the notes are played one finger after the other.

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No. 3 - Finger Pattern 1-4-3-4-2-4

Start at the 5th fret, 6th string, 1st finger and use the one-finger-per-fret rule.

The first system of music consists of a treble clef staff in 6/4 time and a guitar TAB staff. The treble staff contains three measures of music. Above the staff, fingerings are indicated: 1 4 3 4 2 4, 1 4 3 4 2 4, and 1 4 3 4 2 4. The notes are: G4 (1), A4 (4), B4 (3), C5 (4), D5 (2), E5 (4); G4 (1), A4 (4), B4 (3), C5 (4), D5 (2), E5 (4); G4 (1), A4 (4), B4 (3), C5 (4), D5 (2), E5 (4). The TAB staff has three measures with fret numbers: 5 8 7 8 6 8, 5 8 7 8 6 8, and 5 8 7 8 6 8. The letters T, A, and B are stacked vertically on the left side of the TAB staff.

The second system of music consists of a treble clef staff in 6/4 time and a guitar TAB staff. The treble staff contains three measures of music. Above the staff, fingerings are indicated: 1 4 3 4 2 4, 1 4 3 4 2 4, and 1 4 3 4 2 4. The notes are: G4 (1), A4 (4), B4 (3), C5 (4), D5 (2), E5 (4); G4 (1), A4 (4), B4 (3), C5 (4), D5 (2), E5 (4); G4 (1), A4 (4), B4 (3), C5 (4), D5 (2), E5 (4). The TAB staff has three measures with fret numbers: 5 8 7 8 6 8, 5 8 7 8 6 8, and 5 8 7 8 6 8. The letters T, A, and B are stacked vertically on the left side of the TAB staff.

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Single String Chromatic Scales

These scales teach you the musical alphabet and every note on the guitar.

Memorize the pattern but don't worry about reading the notes.

The fingering is the same for all the strings (1-2-3-4 on every four frets).

Say the note names out loud.

1st String - E Chromatic

I. V. IX. V. I.

0 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1 0

E F F# G G# A A# B C C# D D# E Eb D Db C B Bb A Ab G Gb F E

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 11 10 9 8 7 6 5 4 3 2 1 0

T
A
B

2nd String - B Chromatic

B C C# D D# E F F# G G# A A# B Bb A Ab G Gb F E Eb D Db C B

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 11 10 9 8 7 6 5 4 3 2 1 0

T
A
B

3rd String - G Chromatic

G G# A A# B C C# D D# E F F# G Gb F E Eb D Db C B Bb A Ab G

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 11 10 9 8 7 6 5 4 3 2 1 0

T
A
B

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4th String - D Chromatic

D D $\sharp$ E F F $\sharp$ G G $\sharp$ A A $\sharp$ B C C $\sharp$ D D $\flat$ C B B $\flat$ A A $\flat$ G F $\sharp$ F E E $\flat$ D

T
A
B

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 11 10 9 8 7 6 5 4 3 2 1 0

5th String - A Chromatic

A A $\sharp$ B C C $\sharp$ D D $\sharp$ E F F $\sharp$ G G $\sharp$ A A $\flat$ G F $\sharp$ F E E $\flat$ D D $\flat$ C B B $\flat$ A

T
A
B

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 11 10 9 8 7 6 5 4 3 2 1 0

6th String - E Chromatic

E F F $\sharp$ G G $\sharp$ A A $\sharp$ B C C $\sharp$ D D $\sharp$ E E $\flat$ D D $\flat$ C B B $\flat$ A A $\flat$ G G $\flat$ F E

T
A
B

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 11 10 9 8 7 6 5 4 3 2 1 0

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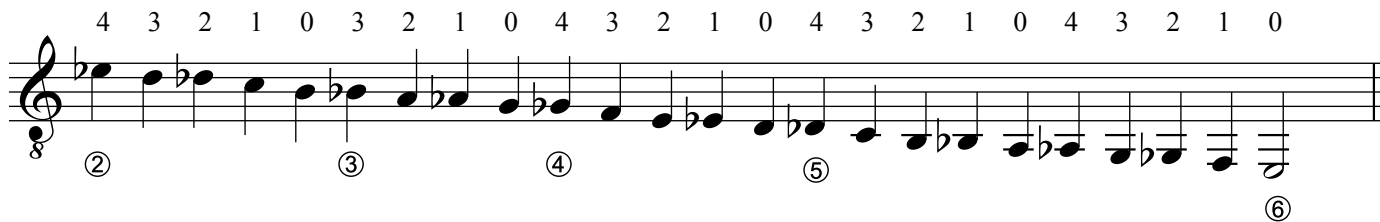
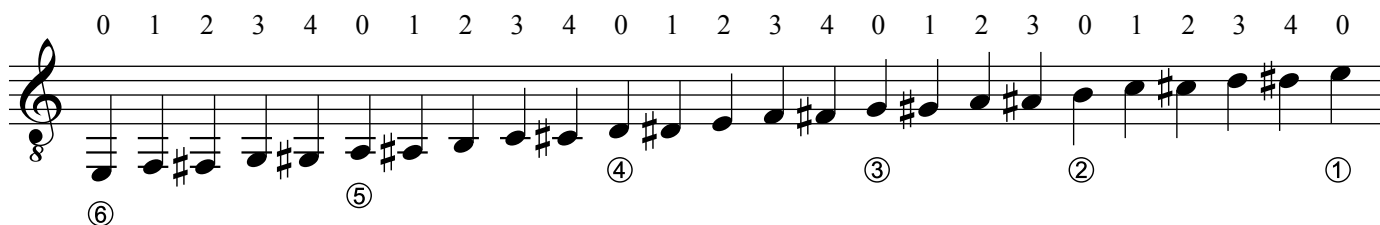
Scales

I have included a small number of scales in preparation for the next level of study. Beginners should continue to my Volume Two method book to fully understand the theory of scales, arpeggios, and key signatures. Use i-m and m-a alternation for all scales.

E Chromatic 1 Octave



E Chromatic 2 Octaves



One Octave Major Scales

These scales have been left unfingered for flexibility in teaching styles.
Key Signatures will be discussed in my Volume 2 method book.
I have added accidentals in addition to the key signature.

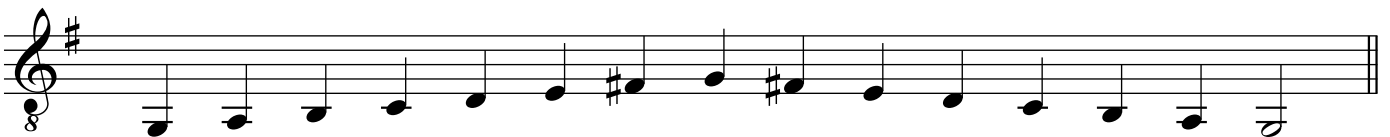
C Major



G Major Upper Octave



G Major Lower Octave



F Major



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A Natural Minor



E Natural Minor



D Natural Minor



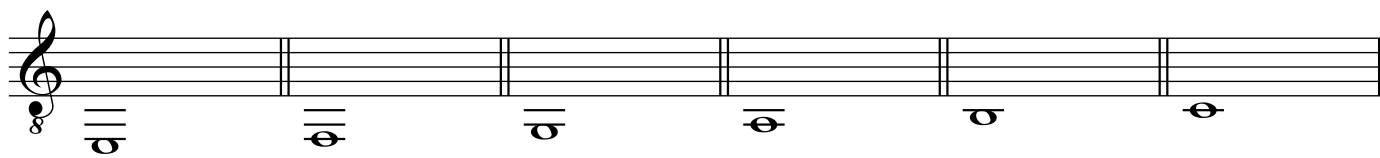
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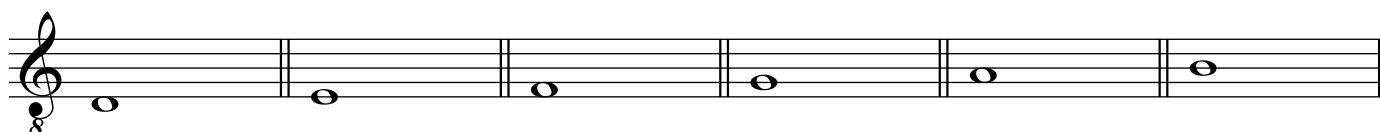
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Reference for Basic First Position Notes

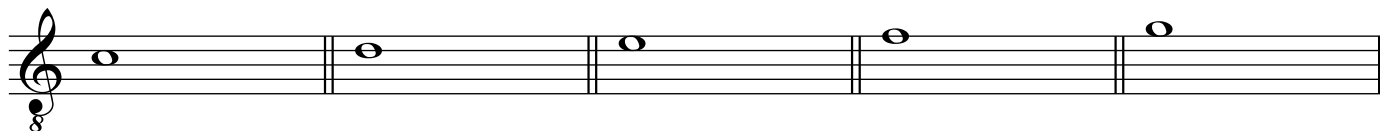
Review the notes you've learned as you progress through the book.
I suggest colouring each new note with a yellow highlighter as you learn.



E	F	G	A	B	C
6th string open	6th string 1st fret 1st finger	6th string 3rd fret 3rd finger	5th string open	5th string 2nd fret 2nd finger	5th string 3rd fret 3rd finger



D	E	F	G	A	B
4th string open	4th string 2nd fret 2nd finger	4th string 3rd fret 3rd finger	3rd string open	3rd string 2nd fret 2nd finger	2nd string open



C	D	E	F	G
2nd string 1st fret 1st finger	2nd string 3rd fret 4th finger	1st string open	1st string 1st fret 1st finger	1st string 3rd fret 4th finger

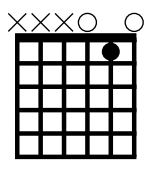
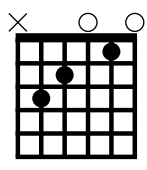
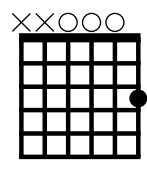
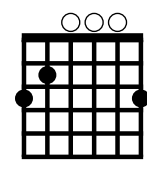
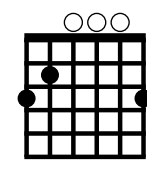
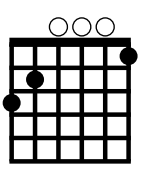
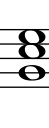
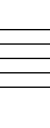
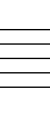
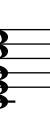
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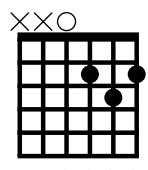
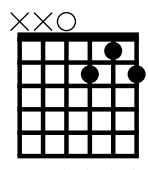
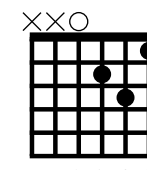
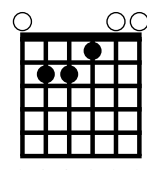
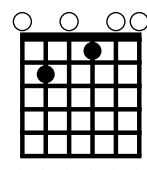
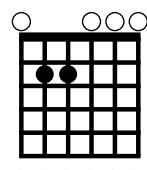
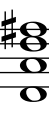
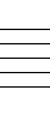
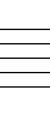
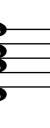
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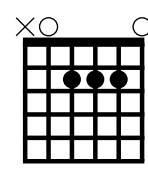
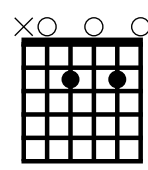
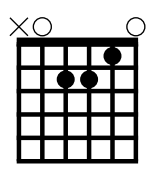
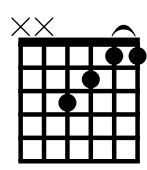
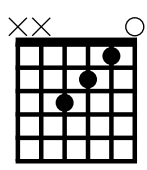
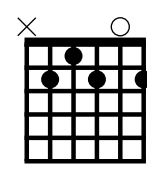
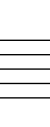
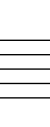
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Chord Reference

Not all of the below chords were covered in this book, addition chords have been added for the benefit of supplemental materials. I suggest colouring each new chord with a yellow highlighter as you learn.

C	C	G	G	G	G ⁷
					
0 1 0	3 2 0 1 0	0 0 0 3	2 1 0 0 0 3	3 2 0 0 0 4	3 2 0 0 0 1
					

D	D ⁷	Dm	E	E ⁷	Em
					
0 1 3 2	0 2 1 3	0 2 4 1	0 2 3 1 0 0	0 2 0 1 0 0	0 2 3 0 0 0
					

A	A ⁷	Am	F	Fmaj ⁷	B ⁷
					
0 1 2 3 0	0 1 0 2 0	0 2 3 1 0	3 2 1 1	3 2 1 0	2 1 3 0 4
					

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